BEAMSTRIKE 1.22
CORE RULES

15mm Miniatures Sci-Fi Rules 2009

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Preface to Version 1.22

Welcome to Beamstrike version 1.22, the free 15mm sci- fi miniatures game. This version remains the same as version 1.20, but includes a few updates and formatting changes, along with some omissions from the last version. Version 1.22 is fully compatible with version 1.20. Thanks to everyone who has continued to contribute to this project, and very happy gaming to you all. Thanks for choosing Beamstrike.

SECTION 1- INTRODUCTION

Beamstrike - The miniature game- is a set of fast paced, simple, science fiction war-game rules for tabletop battles using 15mm model miniature figures. A wide range of armoured vehicles can be fielded, from Tanks, to Walkers and Mecha. Rules for alien races, including generic 'bugs' and 'greys', add interest, and full rules allowing robots and androids complete the sci-fi repertoire.

Beamstrike is not a strict war game as weapon ranges are compressed heavily to accommodate your army on a table of manageable size, comprehensive rules regarding chain of command and communications between various levels of command are largely ignored, and force organization and structure are fairly flexible.

Beamstrike is best described as a fun, fast paced, science fiction 'spaghetti western' of a system, which will not take you 3 months to read and learn, and will not lead to bankruptcy by forcing you to purchase expensive miniatures which must be used in order to play the game according to the rules.

Materials required to play

To play Beamstrike, you will require a suitable selection of 15mm science fiction miniatures and vehicles, a copy of these rules, a tape measure, plain paper to record army statistics and four, six, ten, twelve and twenty sided dice. To further enhance play, a selection of 15mm scenery (such as buildings, hills, trees and other landscape features), notebooks, access to an internet connected computer (to download extra rules and play aids), and even more miniatures are desirable.

Optionally (but recommended), is the novel 'Borrowed Time' by Don Clarke (note this volume contains adult material). This offers greater insight into the Borrowed Time Era of the timeline presented here.

It is possible, though a little difficult, to play Beamstrike on your own, taking turns to play each 'Commander'. Far more interesting and challenging is to get one or more of your friends involved, lend them the rules to look over in advance, and provide some figures for their first game. The first games you play should be reasonably straight forward, 'patrol' type missions with relatively few figures per side (say 300 points each), for a game lasting a couple of hours. As you gain more confidence with the rule systems you can expand the points values fielded and the complexity of the mission scenario and victory conditions.

Wargame conventions

DICE ROLLS

If you have already played war games or role-playing games, the abbreviations used for dice rolls will make sense. For everyone else, please read on. The dice you are used to are 6 sided. This type of die (die is singular for dice) is called a 'D6', the 'D' stands for dice, and the 6, for 6 sided. Following on from this, D4, D10, D12 stand for 4, 10 and 12 sided dice respectively.

Dice with a number of sides other than 6, are available from model/ hobby shops or online. Where d100 rolls are called for, roll 2 D10. One die represents the 'tens' and the other the 'units' (which dice is the tens is decided beforehand!- the dice are usually different colours). For example, 2D10 are rolled, a '6' is rolled for the first dice, and an '8' is rolled for the second. The percentile dice roll is thus '68'

A selection of Dice needed to play Beamstrike (from left to right): D4, D6, D8, D10, D12, D20.

PLAYING PIECES

If you have played board games before, you are probably familiar with the 'playing piece' for your team being represented with a metal or plastic token of some kind. You used this token to show where you were on the board, and in the case of some games like 'Cluedo', you may have chosen the figure to be like you or a character you liked or identified with.

War games take this concept a step further, with lots of 'playing pieces', each representing a single trooper in your army.

The army you assemble, paint and use will be unique and individual, and based on your likes and dislikes. Painting and choosing your army is a hobby in itself, with many modelers taking great pride in assembling and painting to a very high standard.

The colour scheme you decide on will be your choice, commonly camouflage and dull shades of green are used, but this doesn't have to be the case, you may paint your figures however you wish, and some pretty garish colour schemes often look the most striking on the battlefield. Suggested colour schemes for armies are found in the 4 Era supplements.

OPEN SOURCE RULES

These rules are 'open source', a term usually applied to computer software, which means you may freely use and copy these rules as wished, but any future rule sets you make which are mostly based on this set, must be free as well.

POINTS VALUES AND ARMY LISTS

The value of a points system in war-games is a hotly debated subject. Experienced players will probably wish to construct their own forces based around a suitable scenario, whilst others like the simplicity of assigning a certain number of points to each player and seeing what armies they come up with. The points values are suggestions, and it is entirely up to you whether you use them. Some points values assigned to vehicles/ items have not been thoroughly play tested, so bear in mind if points are used, you may have unequal rival forces still.

REAL FUTURE WAR VERSES BEAMSTRIKE WAR

Modern day and near future real war is increasingly likely to be more about stealth and high technology than lots of troops running around and slugging it out on a battlefield, like what happened in ancient times. Combat in the far future may well involve targeting of hostile forces from space/ low orbit and guided missiles or beam weapons surgically removing threats with minimal collateral damage.

Enemy planets may even be 'planet- busted' with incredibly powerful bombs/ missiles. Use of sophisticated cloaking devices, guidance and imaging systems will mean battles are staged at longer and longer ranges, with less and less involvement of Human Soldiers on the ground. Robot and Android developments will mean that the 'artificial soldier' will be used more and more. Very distant-future War may even be so far removed from what we currently think of as 'conflict', as to be unrecognizable.

Beamstrike advocates the use of nicely coloured figures in clunking suits of armour, using weapons with pitifully short ranges, getting up close and personal with their opponents, both on foot and in vehicles. The use of anthropomorphic mecha, hover tanks and walkers on spindly legs and guns like lasers, bolters and 'Sun guns' look great on the miniature war-game table, but realistically these weapon categories would probably be very inefficient and of doubtful battlefield use. Thus Beamstrike (and many of its contemporaries) may well be not very realistic or accurate, and is probably more akin to 'World War 2 with laser guns'-but that is what the rules set out to do, take it or leave it, it is not a tactical simulation.

Having said this, there will probably always be some need for close up combat involving individual troops, where the 'enemy' are located in an area of value (where nuking the site from orbit is not the best option), where hostages need keeping alive, in civilian riots (if you don't like killing your own people indiscriminately) etc. It is entirely up to you how 'realistic' you want your scenarios to be.

A final word would be that these rules are not intended as some sort of accurate prediction of how future war will be fought, and never will be. They will however give the players a few hours of fun, with nobody getting hurt (Your pride excluded perhaps!)

CREDITS AND CONTRIBUTIONS

A full list of credits and thanks appears at the end of this book, lots of people have been involved in creating this free rules set, and the Imperial Commander rules set by Tabletop games was a big inspiration .

SECTION 2 -THE RULES

Beamstrike is divided into 5 sections, you have just read section 1 which gives a basic introduction to the game, its setting and scope. Section 2 details all of the basic rules needed to play the game with troops on foot, providing examples where each new rule concept is introduced.

Section 3 introduces vehicles, bigger weaponry, and energy shields. Section 4 discusses how to actually go about tabletop wargaming, with suggestions on the use of scenery and how this affects play and example scenarios for your first battles. Section 5 outlines the Beamstrike official background, including the Era based on Don Clarke's novel 'Borrowed Time'.

Aliens are referenced in section 6 and finally section 7 details weapon notes, author credits, and gives play aids such as a quick reference sheet, counters and blast templates.

Troops in Beamstrike

The main 'playing piece' in a war game such as Beamstrike is the infantryman or trooper. This is your alter ego on the battlefield, and will be the most numerous of commodities. Troops are classified firstly by the level of protection they have, or battlefield 'survivability', due to their armour and any shields worn, and secondly by the level of training they possess which governs their prowess with firearms, hand to hand combat weapons, and general competence on the battlefield.

ARMOUR	Abbreviation used in these rules	Description of armour level
Unarmoured	**UA**	No armour, only regular clothing. Often civilians, low-tech troops, freedom-fighters, or terrorists have no armour at all.
Fast Infantry	**FI**	Infantry able to move and react quickly, but wearing only light ballistic armour. Scout troops and local law enforcement will be armoured in this way on many planets. Segregation Era troops will mostly be fast infantry.
Light Armoured	**LA**	Troops wearing full suits of metallic or ballistic, reactive, composite armour with full helmets and integrated breathing apparatus. Regular battle infantry in the Imperial Era will be issued with this type of armour. Modified suits can be used in underwater and space settings.
Power Armoured	**PA**	Heavy armour with a powered exo-skeletal structure, allowing heightened close combat ability, battlefield survivability, and increased heavy weapon carrying allowance. Armour of this type replaces the need for light armoured vehicles in some systems, as few small arms found amongst the civilian population are effective against it.
Assault Dreadnought	**AD**	The heaviest armour level, a thick armour plated powered suit. Used in War situations, or where heavy firepower is needed in a situation/ location that is unsuitable for larger combat vehicles. A little slow, but AD wearing troops can pack a real punch on the battlefield. Immune to attacks from Low and standard power weapons.

NOTE ON ARMOUR: Although Powered and Assault Dreadnought armour are both heavy and large in the Imperial Era of the future timeline, eventually these types are no more bulky than light armour in very advanced civilizations. The battle suits used by the Sacred Band (circa UCH 500) are Assault Dreadnought class but much smaller and lighter (and with much higher movement capability) than the clunking Dreadnought suits of the Imperial era.

Training Level

Troop training level impacts on small arms fire, hand to hand combat, weapon maintenance and many other sections of the rules. Most troops in organised armies will be in the 'regular' category. Higher training levels cost more points per figure.

Training type	Abbreviation used in these rules	Description
Civilian	**CIV**	Individuals with no combat training
Regular	**REG**	Average, trained troops but who have had limited battlefield experience.
Veteran	**VET**	Battle-hardened, experienced, well trained troops
Elite	**ELI**	Troops which have been trained to a high level, including advanced weaponry and combat techniques.
Hero	**HER**	See below.

HEROES

Denotes a particularly capable individual with multiple skills and bonuses in combat, heroes are worth taking a little time over, to flesh out a background story with motivations and goals. Some examples are given in each of the Era supplements. Note that some particularly famous (infamous?) individuals may be present in a battle, after agreement of both players, but who if 'killed', will not be permanently dead, but just removed from the action for that battle. This is similar to the way in which well known heroes and villains from movies stay alive throughout a series of battles and keep 'popping up' to enhance a story line in a campaign. See

the section on heroes for their bonuses and use in the Beamstrike game. Any number of heroes may be purchased and fielded, but bear in mind the high points cost and variable nature of skills and hit bonuses which are rolled for.

Troop dice rolls

At some points in the rules, a troop dice roll is made using 1d6. The chance of success is based on the general quality of the troops in question and is directly related to their training level. To pass the roll, a score equal or higher than that listed below is needed on 1d6. The direct results of passed or failed rolls will be described wherever such rolls are called for.

Civilian/ Irregulars : 6	Veteran: 4	Vehicles: 4
Regular: 5	Elite: 3	Hero: 2

Troop skills

There are several special skills/ attributes available for troops, allowing them enhanced battlefield capabilities. Each skill has a points cost, and there may be restrictions on the total numbers of troops which may be given that attribute. Keep track of which figures have been given special characteristics by means of special models, which can be painted with distinctive colours (rather than the standard troop colours). Snipers can be represented by models with rifles and camouflaged uniforms, medics can be given red/ white crosses on their uniforms, and sappers may be modeled with 'suitcase' type backpacks indicating demolition packs. Alternatively, 'skilled' troops can have counters placed next to them indicating their special attribute.

NUMBER OF SKILLS ALLOWED.
Civilian troops may not choose any skills/ characteristics from the list below, regular and veteran troops may have 1 skill, and elite troops may have 2 skills maximum. Heroes are allocated multiple skills according to the section on heroes.

LEADERSHIP (8 points per figure)
The leadership skill gives several bonuses throughout the rules, for example, units with a leader may engage targets other than the nearest, have a better chance of calling in off table fire support, may be rallied when an army's morale breaks etc. Up to 1 figure per unit/ squad may be given this skill. Note a MINIMUM of one leader per army MUST be chosen.

SNIPER (3 points)
A trooper with sniper skill specializes in killing at long range with a high powered rifle, equipped with an advanced targeting scope. Snipers get enhanced fire/ concealment bonuses when deployed, and can 'pick off' enemy leaders and support troops. A maximum of 3 snipers per army are allowed. (See the section on snipers below) ONLY snipers may use the sniper laser and sniper rifles weapons from the weapons chart.

SAPPER (2 points)
A 'sapper', or military engineer is a skilled individual who basically 'saps' the enemy of its fortifications and structural strengths. Figures designated as sappers may use demolition charges (see demolition rules), may lay minefields, deactivate booby traps, and may deactivate/ destroy enemy defense systems (See section 3 of the rules). There is no maximum number of sappers allowed in an army, although many games have limited need for such individuals.

GRENADIER (2 points)
A trooper who is specially trained and equipped for throwing grenades. Grenadiers can also be employed as shock troops, specializing in close assault. Each grenadier gets a +2 bonus to hit with thrown grenades, gets a +1 bonus to the roll to see if troops in cover are injured by exploding hand grenades and gets a +1 bonus in hand to hand combat. Any number of grenadiers may be fielded in battle, usually organised into squads.

MEDIC (3 points, includes medical equipment)
A medic is a trooper who in addition to his normal weapons, also carries a medical kit and has been trained in battlefield medical techniques. Each medic may attempt to 'heal' one fallen comrade per turn, who would normally be removed as killed at the end of the fire phase. Up to 3 medics per army may be chosen. Note that in battles with human forces, general convention dictates that Medic figures should not be singled out and shot at if there are other members of the squad in range/ visible to the firer. If medics *are* shot at, they may make a 'save' roll (See the 'picking off leaders' rules). If a Medic is removed as killed, there is no reduction in moral strength.

FANATIC (3 points)
This characteristic is generally restricted to certain Rebel troops, some Aliens, and most classes of war droid/ robot. Fanatic troops generally do not retreat, even when an armies morale is broken, but can be difficult to control in combat, often advancing when

common sense would dictate staying in cover. See the army lists for troop types classed as fanatic, and the leadership rules for more information on fanatic troops.

GUNNER (1 point)
This skill allows the trooper to fire tripod mounted light artillery and weapons from the heavy weapons list without penalty. (Unskilled troops may fire light artillery, but with a -2 hit penalty) This skill is NOT required to fire Squad support weapons.

SCOUT (3 points)
This skill includes extra training and experience in jet pack jumping, laser painting, and concealment and give bonuses in each of these areas. Up to 2 squads of scouts may be fielded per army. Scouts are particularly useful if used as jump-troops equipped with laser painters and long range rifles, in hit and run scenarios.

SWORDSMAN (3 points)
Individuals trained in the martial arts, especially in the use of advanced hand to hand combat weapons like force swords and power axes. Troops with this skill have 4 added to their 1d10 roll in hand to hand combat. Some melee weapons may ONLY be used by troops with swordsman skill.

EQUIPPING TROOPS

There are sensible logistic limits on how many weapons/ pieces of equipment each trooper may carry, and these limits MUST not be exceeded. The standard organised troop types listed in the Era supplements are provided to give an idea of the armaments and equipment generally carried by various forces.

If custom troop types are being created, or you are not using the Beamstrike background information, abide by the following guidelines, which are based on the armour class of the trooper.

Troop Armour	Hand weapon	Pistol	Main weapon	Number of pieces of equipment
UA	1	1	1	1
FI	1	2	1	3
LA	1	2	1	3
PA	1	2	3	3
AD	1	0	4	4

The numbers in the boxes are the MAXIMUM number of that type of item a single trooper in that category may carry, he may (and usually does) carry much less. Note that a main weapon slot may be used to carry a pistol or hand weapon instead.

- **Hand weapon:** is any hand to hand melee weapon, for example a sword. (Note heroes may carry 2 hand weapons)
- **Pistol:** is any pistol weapon (inc. Palm flamer) or grenade pack from the infantry weapon list.
- **Main weapon**: is any weapon carried by troops in the Infantry weapon list or squad support weapon list (including pistols and grenade packs)
- **Equipment:** Digimedics, targetters, laser painters etc..

CIVILIANS
Civilian grade figures, may not usually carry a main weapon, so melee weapons, pistols, and long rifle weapons only. Note that this does depend on the Era your games are set in and the Governmental restrictions which may be in place on certain planets or in regional Empires. Civilians may not be equipped with Power or Dreadnought armour, as a certain training level is needed to operate powered armour effectively.

TARGETERS
The targeter bonus is only applied to the figures MAIN carried weapon (unless otherwise stated), so if a trooper has a gyrobolt rifle and a pistol, he would get the targeter bonus on the rifle only. The support targeter functions as a normal targeter when it is not deployed in the support role. Note that it is allowed to have more than one targeter per figure. Targetters cannot be fitted to weapons on the tank gun list, as these use the vehicular targeting system and the 'to hit' figures for these weapons already include this.

POWERED/ ASSAULT DREADNOUGHT ARMOUR WEAPON PACKS
PA and AD armoured troops may either be given one main weapon as other troop classes, or have weapons installed in large arm 'packs'. Weapons are usually carried in 2 packs, one on each arm. A maximum of 3 infantry weapons or 2 squad support weapons can be fitted in a single pack (or the figure would tip over!) Any targeters fitted must state which weapon pack they are attached to, and give a hit bonus to all weapons in that pack only. Total weapons carried must not exceed limits in table above.

SPECIAL ITEMS
Agreed before the game begins, these could be nuclear bombs which need placing, suitcases containing important documents, or anything which a figure can carry which is pivotal to a mission outcome.

SEQUENCE OF PLAY

The sequence of play in Beamstrike is determined in an ordered manner according to the chart below. The battle is divided into a number of GAME TURNS, each consisting of 2 PLAYER TURNS. Within each PLAYER TURN are several PHASES.
Note with this system there are two 'movement' phases per player turn and a firing phase in which BOTH players may fire, casualties only being removed from play after both players have fired with all eligible figures.
The morale status of each army is monitored twice per turn. There are 'turn sequence monitor' sheets available to help commanders keep track of the battles progress, by placing a mark in the boxes as each turn phase is reached. Turn monitor sheets can be downloaded from the Yahoo group page.
Player A will usually be the attacker in games/ scenarios which call for an attacker and a defender, otherwise both players roll 1d10, the highest scorer chooses to be either player A or B. If more than 2 players are present with their own opposed armies, player C, D etc would follow on after player B, with the same sequence of game PHASES.

PLAY SEQUENCE CHART

PLAYER	GAME PHASE	DESCRIPTION/ NOTES
A	**First MOVE**	Player A may move any or all of his figures as outlined in the movement rules.
A and B	**FIRE**	Both players may use ranged fire with all eligible figures and vehicles- see the firing rules. Firing is treated as simultaneous, so casualties are not removed until the end of the fire phase (Unless Concealed units get the special FIRST SHOT)
A and B	**Morale checks**	Both players check morale strengths of their armies
A	**Second MOVE**	Player A may again move with any or all figures and vehicles, even if they moved during the first movement phase.
A	**Close Combat**	Player A makes troop rolls for all squads within 5cm of an enemy, successful troops may make a close combat action, as detailed in the close combat rules.
B	**First MOVE**	As per player A descriptions, player Bs turn follows the same sequence of events but with player B moving and making close combat troop rolls.
A and B	**FIRE**	
A and B	**Morale checks**	
B	**Second MOVE**	
B	**Close Combat**	
BOTH	**END OF TURN**	Any turn related events are rolled for (such as weather conditions), and the turn comes to an end. Another turn starting with player A is then commenced.

MOVEMENT RATES OF TROOPS AND VEHICLES

This section of the rules details movement rates for each of the troop and vehicle types and allowed actions. Note that in Beamstrike an element may move OR perform an action in each move phase but not both.
In each of the two movement phases of his player turn, the player may either move his figures and vehicles anything up to the distances given in the movement table, OR figures may perform any one of the actions detailed on the Action table.

MOVEMENT NOTES:
Hover-powered vehicles may pass over scenery up to 1 inch high and treat this as 'Road', (Scenery such as small boulders, bushes, low walls). Anti- grav vehicles may cruise up to 3 inches in height to clear obstacles such as high walls, small buildings, trees etc and treat as 'open ground'
Any scenery placed on the battlefield should be classified BEFORE play as to how it will affect movement.

Where troops or vehicles cross more than one type of terrain in a single move, they move at the rate of: Terrain type1 + terrain type 2 divided by 2.

Example: A UCH wheeled armoured personnel carrier is traveling on road, then wants to turns off to move over open ground. It moves (12+8)/2= 10 inches that move phase. This simplistic yet reasonably fair system avoids complicated mathematics for calculating proportionate movement.

TROOP AND VEHICLE MOVEMENT TABLE

	Movement Rate (In Inches) per movement phase				
Troop/ Vehicle type	Road	**Open ground** grassland, scrub.	**Light woods,** boggy ground, bush land, Slopes, desert sand	Difficult Medium woods, boulders, light ruins and rubble, steep slopes	**Very Difficult** Heavy woods, jungle, rubble strewn ruins, etc
UA	5	4	3	2	1
FI/ LA	5	4	3	3	2
PA	4	3	2	2	1
AD	3	2	2	1	1
Fast Wheeled (FW)	14	10	6	6	2
Wheeled (W)	12	8	6	4	Not allowed
Fast tracked (FT)	10	9	8	6	2
Tracked (T)	8	8	8	6	2
Heavy tracked (HT)	6	6	6	4	1
Anti-grav (G)	12	10	8	8	3
Hover (H)	10	10	8	8	Not allowed
Fast grav/ Fast hover/Jetcycle (FG)	14	14	12	10	4
Legged (L)	10	10	8	6	4
Heavy legged (HL)	5	5	4	3	2
Limbs (L)	12	11	8	6	4
Heavy Limbs (HL)	8	6	5	4	3

ACTIONS TABLE

Figure may perform ANY ONE of the following actions per movement phase INSTEAD of moving.

ACTION	DESCRIPTION
Enter or leave a vehicle	May leave a stationary vehicle, figure must be placed within 1 inch of that vehicle, entering is the reverse. The vehicle itself mat not move at all during this movement phase.
Enter or leave a building	Trooper may move from any point inside of a building to outside the building within 1 inch of any exit. Entering (assuming building is not locked) is the reverse process.
Call off table fire support	See off table support for details, note: call may also be made in firing phase*
Beam up or down	Be beamed to or from a teleport bay to/ from anywhere on the table.
Set explosive (sapper)	Set a demolition pack (See demolition rules)*
Deploy a support weapon	Deploy a support or heavy weapon for effective use (See deployment rules)

*Where these actions are performed in a move phase, the effect is delayed until the next fire phase.

NOTES ON FOOT TROOP GROUND MOVEMENT

Figures moving on foot may move any distance up to the maximum for that terrain type/ troop class as given on movement table. Certain terrain features will restrict movement for some troop types (See section 4 of these rules). In addition, walls over 1 inch will prevent movement across them unless a section is destroyed first. Figures which move off of the game tables agreed boundaries are considered to have left the battle and are considered lost as far as morale and victory conditions are concerned.

SQUADS

In Beamstrike , your troops are usually organised into groups of between 3 and 8 troops, called squads or units.
This is the basic unit of troop formation, all members of a squad usually staying fairly close to each other to allow communication and fire support of each other and close enough to receive orders from any leader present.

UNIT/ SQUAD COHERENCY AND FORMATION

All ground squad members of a unit must stay within 3 inches of at least one other squad member of the same unit, this ensures squad coherency. Distance is measured from any part of one base to any part of another. If the squad moves further apart than this, either from movement choice, or from loss of members during the combat phase, the squad is 'split' and must regroup before it may advance towards an enemy.

If the squad is defending a fortification, or does not intend to move forward, then this rule does not apply, although the instant the squad wishes to advance, it MUST regroup first.

GANG COHERENCE
Some units (Detailed in Era supplements) will have gang coherence. All members of the unit must remain within 3 inches of ALL other members of the unit. Penalty for breaking coherence is as above. Civilians without a leader MUST move in this way.

INDEPENDENT UNITS
Note some figures, ALL HEROES, and all vehicles may act independently, although bear in mind they may not be rallied if too far from a Leader when morale breaks! Independent units are listed at various sections in the rules and in army lists.

GROUND VEHICLE MANOEUVRES
Simple rules follow for turning and manoeuvering vehicles in Beamstrike games, they are intentionally simplistic to avoid detailed record keeping. More examples of terrain and how it affects movement are given in section 4 of this book.

- **TURNING**: Vehicles may change direction by up to 90° in one move phase with no move distance penalty.
- **SHARP TURNS**: If a turn over 90° is made in one turn phase, halve movement distance for that phase.
- **REVERSING:** Vehicles may move backwards at half forward move speed, exceptions are jet cycles which cannot reverse and legged vehicles which reverse at quarter move speed, round any fractions down.

Vehicles which leave the game tables agreed boundaries are assumed to have left the battle and are considered lost as far as morale and victory conditions apply.

AIRCRAFT
In Beamstrike games, small support/ Ground attack aircraft are permitted to be fielded. Larger fixed wing aircraft and low orbit spacecraft are outside the scope of the game, but are instead represented by the Off table fire support rules.
Aircraft apply to small aircraft with hover/ Grav / VTOL ability (See the vehicle lists and classifications for lists of flying vehicles) Aircraft have relatively high acceleration rates and maximum speeds. Instead of a fixed movement allowance, in each of the players move phases they are permitted to perform ONE of the following actions:

AIRCRAFT MANOEUVER	DESCRIPTION
Take Off	Vehicle is considered airborne and above the take off point at 'ground attack' altitude.
Land	Aircraft moves from any altitude/ position on the battlefield to a stationary, landed position on the ground.
Move and/ or change height band	Aircraft may move to anywhere on the game table. The height band may be changed as wished in addition to movement.
Hover	Aircraft is hovering at any height band above a single point on the battlefield

AIRCRAFT ALTITUDE CHOICES
Aircraft can choose to fly at either 'high altitude', 'Low' or 'ground attack'. If the aircraft is at high altitude it cannot be attacked, nor can attack, BUT is airborne and considered in close proximity to the battlefield (model is placed beside the battlefield but is not considered lost). Aircraft at 'Low' altitude can see over, and be seen over any hills, buildings or woods etc. Figures and vehicles firing at aircraft at low altitude must add 20 inches to the range. If the vehicle is in ground attack mode, it is assumed to be no more than 2 inches above the ground and woods and buildings will completely block the line of sight for firing purposes, no modification is made to the range.

EXAMPLES OF DISALLOWED TROOP/ VEHICLE MOVE/ FIRE COMBINATIONS

Troop/ Vehicle type	First Move phase	Fire phase	Second Move phase	Explanatory Notes
Aircraft	land	-	move	Must have taken off first to be able to move
Infantry	Move	Fire	Enter vehicle which has itself moved this phase	Vehicle must be stationary in order to embark troops
Ground vehicle	Reload / repair weapon then move	-	Move	Can either repair weapon OR move in one move phase, not both
Infantry	Move off table	fire	Move back on table	Units which leave the battlefield may not re- enter or fire.
Aircraft	Land and accept troops	fire	move	Vehicle must be stationary in the same phase that troops embark/ disembark
Support weapon	move	Fire with bonus	move	1 move phase is used to 'deploy' a support/ heavy weapon before its bonus is applied

JET PACKS
Jet packs are self powered backpacks strapped securely to the figure, allowing troops to make short airborne 'leaps' over obstacles and into battle. A jet pack move may be made in either or both of the player's movement phases. A single powered leap of anything up to the distance given on the following chart below may be made. Note that unarmoured troops and civilians may not use jet packs.

Troop type	Jump distance in inches	Troop type	Jump distance in inches
LA infantry	10	Light Mecha	20
Fast infantry	16	Medium Mecha	14
PA infantry	8	Heavy Mecha	8
AD infantry	6	Trooper has 'scout' skill: +3 inches to jump	

Jet pack troops may jump over scenery/ vehicles or other troops. A powered jump is usually considered to be half as high as it is long, so a trooper jumping 16 inches may clear an obstacle up to 8 inches in height at the jumps middle point. Higher jumps may be made, but for each 1 inch extra height jumped, 2 inches in jump length is lost. For example an PA trooper wishes to jump over a building 5 inches in height. His total jump distance is reduced to 6 inches.

Jet packs do have limitations, and there are some dangers associated with their use. Jump troops may not jump into or out of light, medium or heavy wooded areas, or jump from *moving* vehicles or from building windows. Stationary or hovering vehicles with open tops may be jumped from if at ground attack altitude or landed/ ground based. Troops on building roofs may jump to another building roof and troops on a building roof may jump to the ground, as long as the building height is less than the jump distance.
If troops jump to somewhere they cannot see from the jump start position (i.e. line of sight is blocked to the intended landing point), or jump off a building taller than their jump distance, there is a risk of a jet pack accident. For each figure jumping, roll 2d6 and consult the chart below. If the 2d6 score is equal to or higher than the accident score then that figure has had a jump injury/ mishap and is removed from play (counts as killed for morale and victory purposes)

JET PACK ACCIDENTS (Roll 2D6)

Troop type	Accident score
Fast Infantry	12
Light Armoured Infantry	11
Power armoured Infantry	10
Assault Dreadnought Armour/ Mecha	9

NOTE: Troops with 'scout' skill deduct 1 from the 2d6 accident roll.

Q-TRAVEL PODS
Q-Travel pods are quantum teleportation devices, the receive/ transmit pod sent to the battlefield is an armour plated platform with a powerful energy source, narrow beam transmitter and giga- storage device. The mind bogglingly huge amount of data which needs to be communicated to teleport living beings (around 10^{37} bits of information, enough to fit on a cubic kilometer of contemporary CD- ROMS), is only available on the computers of the far future. Each Q-travel pod can transport up to 5 figures of any troop class or a light vehicle (vehicles up to hull class 2), in each movement phase. The high points cost of Q- travel pods includes the orbital craft support and control mechanisms. A Q-travel pod is destroyed on any 'KILL' result from ranged fire, and counts as a stationary assault dreadnought armoured troop for armour purposes. Glancing hit results have no effect. Q- travel pods may be inactivated by any trooper in base to base contact armed with a power or a force weapon. Q- travel platforms must be placed on the battlefield before play commences.

POD USE:
Q- travel pods are used to deploy forces, move existing forces to another Q-pod, add reinforcements and evacuate troops from a battlefield, see reinforcement rules.

Example: A Sacred Band squad moves into a Q-travel pod in its first move phase, fires in the fire phase, then moves to a second Q- travel pod in the second move phase.

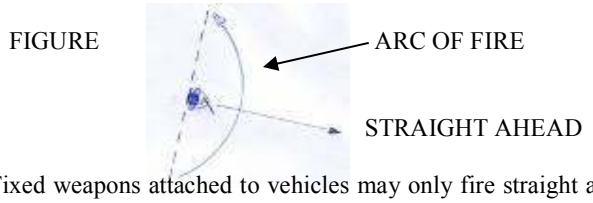
Note that as troops must move into or out of a Q- travel pod, the bay can only in fact be used in one move phase per player turn so it spends the other waiting for troops to enter or clear the pod.

BASIC RANGED COMBAT

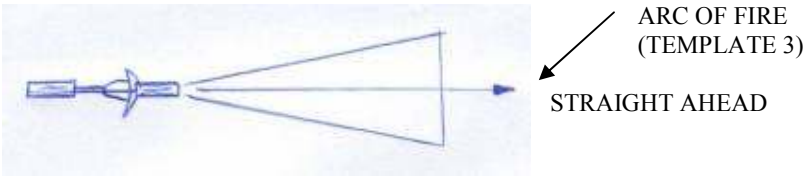
This includes all ranged small arms fire, vehicular weapon fire, fire support, deployed support/ heavy weapon fire.

CAN YOU FIRE AT THE TARGET?
To fire at a target, the target must be within the firers arc of fire, a line of sight to the target must exist (unless indirect support weapon being used, see below) and the target must be within the maximum range of the weapon used. We will look at each in turn.

ARCS OF FIRE
Troops may only fire at targets which are within 90° of either side of their facing direction as depicted in the diagram below: To determine which direction to figure is facing, you can paint a small mark on the base, and this is the forward centre line. Alternatively just assume the figure is facing in the direction it is looking/ pointing its weapon.



Fixed weapons attached to vehicles may only fire straight ahead in their direction of mounting as depicted in the diagram below (you may use weapon template number 3 to get the angles of fire correct)



Turreted weapons and AI-cannon type weapon pods have a full 360 degree arc of fire and may even fire at targets directly behind them without penalty.

LINE OF SIGHT FOR DIRECT FIRE
For a figure to fire at another figure it needs a 'line of sight' to the target. This means you must be able to see the main body or head of the target (or main vehicle body) before you can shoot it. If all you can see is the end of a gun barrel or vehicle aerial etc… line of sight is blocked. If figures are used in kneeling or prone poses, and line of sight is blocked because of this, both players should agree there and then whether these figures are totally hidden (and therefore line of sight is blocked for both players, or they are in fact visible and both players may fire with them)- these sorts of determinations may add unnecessary complications to the flow of the game however.
An enemy unit which is directly behind a closer enemy unit MAY NOT be selected as a target, line of sight is assumed blocked (A deployed sniper may ignore this rule). A figure may not fire through a friendly figure unless using an indirect fire weapon. If a cover element obscures any part of the targets base from the firers view, then the relevant cover can be claimed by the target.

WHICH TARGET MAY BE CHOSEN?
Normally all the weapons a figure fires must be aimed at the SAME target. The exceptions are:
Heroes with ambidexterity skill.
Multiple weapons in PA/ AD arm packs must be fired at the same target.
Vehicle multiple weapons (except those in the same turret/ AI turret) may be fired at different targets as wished.

The troop training class of the firer governs which enemies may be targeted:

TROOP TRAINING CLASS	ELIGIBLE TARGETS
CIVILIAN	The closest enemy target only.
REGULAR	The closest enemy troops OR any vehicle/ building visible.
VETERAN	Choice of any of the 2 closest targets, or any vehicles/ buildings
ELITE/ HERO	Choice of any of the 3 closest targets, or any vehicles/ buildings

If a leader or Hero with leadership skill is present in the troops squad, its members may fire upon targets not normally available to them on a successful troop dice roll (roll for each figure firing in such a manner). The rules regarding line of sight/ arcs of fire etc must still be obeyed. Note if the troop dice roll fails, that trooper may not fire in that phase. A sniper may fire upon any (except medic) figure on the battlefield without penalty or a troop roll being taken (line of sight etc must still exist)

Vehicles may fire upon any target within range, regardless of crew troop level, as long as line of sight/ arc of fire are OK. This simulates the benefits of the superior targeting systems, avionics and computerized acquisition available in future vehicles.

PICKING OFF LEADERS/ SQUAD SUPPORT WEAPONS/ MEDICS
A controversial issue this, some other contemporary rule sets not allowing individuals to be selectively picked off as leaders may well look just the same as other troops they command, and squad support weapons will be picked up by other members of the squad if the individual carrying them is killed.

In Beamstrike, if a figure with leadership skill, a medic or a squad support weapon carrying individual is targeted by an enemy troop, the leader/ medic/ support weapon soldier may make a troop dice roll (this simulates the leader staying low, keeping back slightly, and not drawing attention to themselves etc). A successful roll means the leader/ medic/ support weapon troop cannot be targeted, so the firer must choose a different target instead.
If the leader/ medic/ support weapon individual is the only member of the unit visible or in range, or is under sniper attack or the only one left (!), this evasion cannot be used.
In history, leaders (where identified) and support weapons have been selectively targeted to cause maximum damage to the enemy and Beamstrike follows this way of thinking.

ALTERNATIVE RULE:
Where prior agreement between players exists, you may wish to ban the selective targeting of individuals, with hits on a squad being assigned randomly or from the figures nearest to the firer, or allow the owner of the targeted figures to select which are removed from play (As is done in Warhammer 40K)

MEASURING RANGE/ TARGETS WITHIN TEMPLATES ETC
Assuming all of your figures are on standard bases, just measure from the base edge of the firer to the base edge of the target figure. Measure vehicle ranges from the edge of the main body of the vehicle, as it may or may not be mounted on a base. When you use template weapons, you may find a figure/ vehicle is just inside/ outside and open to debate. The figure/ vehicle is within the template/ cone and subject to being hit if any part of its base, or any part of a vehicle main body is covered by the template.

For really equivocal situations throw 1d6: 1-3 inside template and is attacked. 4-6 outside template cannot be hit.

BASIC HIT PROCEDURE
Proceed to the Weapon lists (See separate charts pack) and find the section for the specific weapon being fired.
Measure the range to the target (from the edge of the firing figures base to the edge of the targets base) in inches and find out the score needed for a hit with that weapon at the measured range. Apply any modifiers to your dice roll from the hit modifier table. If the range is above the weapon 'maximum range', the shot cannot be taken, as it will miss automatically.

If the modified dice roll is lower than that needed to hit, the shot has missed. If the score is equal to or higher than that needed to hit, a hit is scored on the target. If a natural 12 is rolled (two sixes), a critical hit is scored (see critical hits, below)
For each hit, roll1d6 on the Damage chart for the hits effect, the dice roll for damage is modified by any factors on the Damage Modifier chart, such as targets armour and weapon power.

HIT MODIFIER TABLE

Apply the following hit modifiers to the **2d6 dice roll** to hit. (Optional modifiers in bold are new for this version)

FIRERS TROOP RATING		SUPPRESSION/ MORALE		VEHICLE TARGETS	
Elite	+3	Firer is suppressed	-2	Vehicle bike/ trike/ skimmer	+1
Veteran	+2	Firing at suppressed troops	-1	Vehicle APC /Tank	+2
Regular	+0			**Moving** Air target	-3
Civilian	-2	**TARGETER**		Vehicle is Walker	+3
Hero	Varies(+3 base)			Vehicle is Mecha/ battlesuit	+4
ELEVATION		At 0-8 inches	+1	Tank is 'hull down'	No bonus
Firer on lower ground than target	-1	+2	At 8 inches +	**Ground vehicle moved last phase**	**-2**
Firer higher ground than target	+1	**OTHER**			
COVER		Target is AD trooper	+1	Grenadier throwing grenades	+2
Target soft cover	-1	Firing on building itself	+4	Undeployed squad support weapon	-2
Target hard cover	-2	AI-turret	+1	Target stealth cloaked Firer is doper	-3 -2
Target reinforced cover	-4	**FIGURE MOVEMENT**			
		Firing figure moved last phase	**-2**		
Through smoke	-1	**Target figure moved last phase**	**-1**	Undeployed squad support weapon	-2

WEAPON USE
Figures may only fire one weapon in any given fire phase. Exceptions are:

- Heroes may fire a pistol (including Palm Flamers) in each hand at the same target. Heroes with ambidexterity skill may fire each pistol at a different target. If the Hero has both constitution and ambidexterity skills, he/she may fire any Infantry table weapon (Not Heavy support weapons) from each hand at different targets.
- Multiple weapon packs on PA or AD armoured troops (Several weapons are strapped to the same arm- you can fire all weapons on ONE arm only) Exception-Heroes with ambidexterity can fire any two weapon packs.
- Vehicle weapons- All of a vehicles weapons may fire independently. Weapons with the same facing in fixed or pintle mounts, or in the same turret or AI-turret, must fire at the same target.
- Palm flamers-a weapon that does not really need to be aimed so may be fired wrong handedly- may be fired along with a weapon in the troops other hand.

In all cases throw to hit for each weapon individually.

Infantry Damage table (See charts pack)

The Infantry damage table determines the effect of a hit on a single troop figure. Use the modifier which corresponds to the damage type of the weapon (See weapon lists for this information). The dice roll for damage is modified by any shields etc the target may have. Modified rolls less than 1 are considered to be 1, modified scores above 6, count as 6.

NE= No effect. The shot was deflected by the targets armour, or was just a minor flesh wound. The figure is not affected and may continue as normal. (Multiple hits of no effect still count as no effect)

STUN= Stunned. A stunned figure cannot move or attack for 3 turns (use a suitable marker), unless he can roll a '6' on a D6. (One try per turn following the stun hit). Subsequent stun hits reset the number of turns stunned to 3, never more. A stunned figure may not defend in a hand to hand combat attack, being automatically slain.

GH= Glancing hit. The target was wounded, but not seriously enough to kill or disable, the figures armour absorbed much of the damage, the individual is shaken momentarily and may have fallen over or been knocked back. The target may not move or fire until after the next fire phase. He may defend himself in hand-to-hand combat if attacked. Use a glancing hit marker/ counter provided placed next to the figure. Take the marker away at the end of the next fire phase. If a figure suffers multiple 'glancing hits' in one combat phase, it still just counts as one glancing hit, they're just really lucky!
Note:
2 colours of glancing hit markers are provided to help keep track of which phase the marker was placed. Alternate the colours used each new fire phase.

Kill= Killed/ dead. The figure received either a fatal hit, or a wound serious enough to prevent him from further participation in the battle. The figure is removed from play at the end of the fire phase, unless medical aid is given or victim has a digimedic.

Damage table modifiers

Add the following modifiers to the Damage Table **1d6 dice roll** as appropriate:

FI (Segregation. era)	-1
Alien target	Varies, see Alien supplement
Critical hit	+2
Target is hero with constitution skill	-2

SHIELD DAMAGE TABLE MODIFIERS	
Energy shield against lasers, conversion beamers, and auto blasters	-3
Projectile shield- against explosives, pistols, ramjets, CPP/ bolt guns	-3

Miscelaneous combat rules

NOTES ON CASUALTIES
During a fire phase firing is simultaneous, so casualties on both sides are only removed at the very end of the fire phase when both players have had a chance to fire ALL eligible figures (Exception is the 'first shot' rule for concealed troops, see page 30)

To help keep track, any figures killed (but who haven't fired yet) are placed on their sides, so you know they still get their return shot before being removed. Any heavy weapons figures are carrying are destroyed when they are killed.

MEDICAL AID/ DIGIMEDIC

If a squad has a medic, one of the casualties in that squad, or any other friendly figure within 6 inches of the medic figure may be healed on the roll of a 4 or above on a 1d6.

At the end of the fire phase, the player nominates one figure to receive medical aid per medic available. The nominated figure remains on its side on the battlefield. In the next friendly movement phase, the medic must move to the injured figure and spend the rest of that movement phase with him, at which point the roll is made.

A failed roll means the figure is removed as dead, a passed roll means the figure is unharmed and ready to fight. Note that heroes may also have medical aid skill, as listed in the heroes' skills table. A figure may carry a Digimedic (some armour types can have them built in), which if the figure receives a hit, he may roll 1d6. On a roll of 5-6 a kill result is downgraded to a 'glancing hit', similarly a 'glancing hit' is downgraded to a 'no effect'.

EXAMPLE OF RANGED COMBAT

An elite Interventionist trooper is firing her gyrobolt rifle with targeter at a light armoured Continuationist who is 11 inches away with no cover. The hit score needed with a Gyrobolt rifle at 5-20 inches range is 8.

The following hit modifiers are applied to the firers 2d6 roll to hit:

Elite firer	+3
Targeter at 8 inches+	+2
---	---
TOTAL:	+5

The player throws the 2 dice and scores 5. With the +5 bonus this is a total of 10, a hit is scored. A gyrobolt rifle has a 'high' damage factor; so a +1 modifier is used on the damage table. The target only has light armour which will be another +1 modifier to the 1d6 roll. 1d6 is rolled and a 5 scored, for a modified total of 7 (considered 6), which is a kill against light armour. The figure killed is placed on its side as it will still be able to return fire (if it hasn't fired this phase yet), before being removed.

TEMPLATE WEAPONS

The fire from some weapons spreads out to affect an area, examples are flames from a flamethrower, automatic fire from CPP weapons and the immense chemical energy burst from a sun gun. The fire from these weapons is simulated by the use of a template. The weapon lists indicate which weapons may or must use templates. Place the thin edge of the indicated template marker against the edge of the base of the firing figure, with the cone pointing in any direction within the figures arc of fire. Anything within the cone is a target (including friendly units). Throw separately for each target to hit, in the normal way. Note indiscriminate use of template weapons can result in friendly fire incidents, both embarrassing and detrimental to your chances of winning, use with caution!

WEAPON DEPLOYMENT

Infantry Weapons: Are not deployed

Squad support weapons and indirect fire weapons: A squad support weapon that is fired before deployment suffers a -2 penalty to the hit dice roll.

Heavy weapons and Tripod mounted vehicle weapons:

MUST be deployed before being fired. One move phase is taken to deploy the weapon.

When a weapon is deployed, place a deployment counter next to it. Note vehicle mounted heavy weapons do not need to be deployed before use, considered already 'deployed'. It takes no time at all to pick up a deployed weapon, but then it must be deployed again at its new location for full effect.

SNIPER DEPLOYMENT

Snipers may take 1 move phase to 'deploy' as per machinegun, use an appropriate marker for this. Once deployed however, they may claim cover at one band higher than they actually have. So, no cover becomes soft, soft becomes hard, and hard becomes reinforced. This represents the sniper digging in, using camouflaged clothing, setting up sights etc. The maximum level of cover allowed is 'reinforced'. A deployed sniper also gains bonuses within the 'which target may be chosen' section, and benefits from the follow on fire rules below. An undeployed sniper does not get any bonuses and can only act as a normal trooper with a rifle. Weapons that snipers use are silenced, may use subsonic (quiet) ammunition, use laser beams outside the normal visible spectrum etc, and may have enhanced sighting systems including night/ poor weather capability. Because of this, deployed snipers ignore smoke, and are only 'exposed' after firing from cover on a failed troop roll.

Example: Vladd, the Imperial Veteran sniper has deployed on a hill overlooking a Rebel firebase. His initial observations of the enemies fortifications leads him to decide to take out the gunner on a laser cannon mounted near the entrance to the base, to allow his troops unhampered access. If he fires his sniper laser, in his fire phase, he will only be EXPOSED on a failed veteran troop roll (if he rolls 1-3 on a d6). Otherwise he is still concealed and cannot be fired upon. For more on concealment and exposing troops see the Cover rules later.

OPTIONAL RULE: CRITICAL HITS

This rule may optionally be used, but may result in unexpectedly damaging hits from poor weapons. If a natural 12 (i.e. two sixes) is rolled when throwing the 2d6 to hit, this represents a particularly good or accurate shot. This is termed a 'critical hit' and 2 is added to the 1d6 throw on the Damage chart for assessing damage to figures.

If a vehicle was hit, add 2 to the roll on the armour penetration table, and add 2 when throwing the 1d10 on the vehicle effect of hit chart. Note if a 12 was needed just to hit, it is NOT also a critical hit.

SQUAD SUPRESSION

When a deployed support or heavy weapon, a deployed sniper, a weapon from the tank gun chart, is fired at an enemy foot squad (UA,FI,LA,PA, and AD troops), whether or not a hit is achieved, suppression of that squad may be achieved.

The squad under fire must make a troop roll at the end of the fire phase (use the troop type of the majority of the figures in the squad), modified as below. A failed roll means the whole squad is 'Suppressed' (place suppressed counter next to squad) and remains so until a troop roll is made (one roll can be made per squad at the start of each subsequent fire phase), or the suppressing attacker is destroyed by another friendly unit.

MODIFIERS TO TROOP ROLL FOR SUPRESSION/ REMOVAL OF SUPRESSION					
Leader in squad	+2	Squad less than ½ strength	-1	Beam or flame/ sun weapon	-1
Leader within 12 inches	+1	PA troops	+1	Target squad in heavy cover	+1
Total2 or 3 weapon	-2	AD troops	+2	Target squad reinforced cover	+2

EFFECT OF SUPRESSION:

A suppressed squad MUST move to the NEAREST cover of at least 1 level higher than it currently has unless already in hard/ reinforced cover in the next movement phase. The suppressed squad may not move toward suppressing attacker, unless by doing so it finds better cover in one movement phase.

Once in cover, squad may only now move if it is to the nearest better level of cover, and any weapons fire by the suppressed squad is at a -2 hit penalty until the suppression is removed. As suppressed troops generally have their heads down, or gone prone in open ground, fire now directed at them is at a -1 penalty to hit.

The careful use of suppressive fire and squad support weapons can give a significant advantage to the players army. Note that a squad suppressed by a particular weapon, may again be suppressed by the same weapon later in the game.

WEAPON LISTS (See charts pack)

The Beamstrike weapon tables present a selection of small arms, support and heavy weapons for infantry units. Extra weapons can be inserted as required to fit the science fiction background you are using. For ease of play squads are usually equipped with the same weapon, with perhaps 1 member of the unit having a squad support weapon. Extra weapons may be found in existing or future 'Era' supplements.

WEAPON: The weapon name along with the abbreviation used in Beamstrike

CODE: The abbreviation used for this weapon in the rules

TO HIT SCORE NEEDED: The number you need to roll equal to or higher on 2d6 to score a hit. Note that modifiers will apply to the dice roll.

RANGE BANDS: The score needed to hit gets higher with an increase in range. Note that all weapons have a maximum range, beyond which fire is ineffective and cannot cause significant casualties. Ranges are measured in inches:

- 0-4 inches is point blank range
- 4-20 inches is close range
- 21-40 inches is medium range.
- 41-80 inches is long range
- Over 80 inches is considered Extreme range.

MAX range. Fire over the maximum range of the weapon is not permitted and has no chance of achieving hits.

DAMAGE TYPE: The damage type is a measure of weapon power and is applied as a positive or negative modifier on the damage table.

FIRE TEMPLATE: Lists the template the weapon may or must use.

POINTS COST: The points cost to 'purchase' one weapon of that type for a trooper.

REMARKS: The remarks column lists any further relevant information or notes.

* This weapon is capable of causing squad suppression

** 1pt infantry grenades, 2pts support grenades, 3pts specialised grenades

\+ Throw 1d6 for damage type: 1=low,2= standard, 3-4=High, 5=Power, 6=Total

GRENADES AND INDIRECT FIRE

Troops equipped with grenades may throw them instead of using their normal ranged combat attack. A figure, vehicle or building must be nominated as the 'target'. Roll to hit as normal with 2d6. If the grenade misses, assume the throw was way off the mark and has no effect. If a hit is scored, place the indicated template on the battlefield, with its centre laying over the target. All troops/ vehicles whose bases fall wholly or partially under the blast template are potential targets, their chance of being injured depending on their cover level:

No cover, in open: Automatically hit
Soft cover: Throw a 1d6 per figure, 1-2 miss, 3-6 hit.
Hard cover: Throw a 1d6 per figure, 1-4 miss, 5-6 hit
Reinforced cover: Throw a 1d6 per figure, 1-5 miss, 6 hit.
High wall/ building/ large vehicle in way: Cannot be hit

If grenade was thrown by a figure with 'grenadier' skill, 1 is added to the 1d6 roll above.

Note that a figures cover level is determined by checking what cover is directly in a line between the centre of the blast (ground zero), and the figure. Troops out in the open will be cut down by well placed grenade/ missile hits, whilst those in cover are much less likely to be affected.

The type of grenade thrown depends on what grenade 'pack' the figure is carrying. A figure may carry only one type of pack. There are three 'packs', the standard infantry pack is suitable for most troops most of the time, whilst the support pack includes more powerful variants suitable for anti-vehicular use or heavily armoured troops. The specialized pack contains a wide selection of munitions and counts as a figures 'main weapon' choice. This pack includes the anti-vehicular grenade for armour attacks and the stun grenade, useful for subduing civilians in riot situations. Grenade ammunition is considered unlimited.
A trooper may select any one of the grenades from the carried pack, and throw one per fire phase.

GRENADE AND LAUNCHER AMMO

Assume for each grenade 'pack' unlimited grenades of each type are available, for most games only a few will probably be used per figure anyway. Note that many indirect weapons fire 'grenades' and although the cost is the same per 'pack', the actual munitions will be tailored to the weapon. E.g.: A hand grenade cannot be fired in a grenade launcher and vice- versa. As the damage and bust areas are similar for all these weapons, they are listed as firing 'grenades'.

SMOKE GRENADE

A smoke grenade's impact counts as 'soft cover' for those within the circle of burst, but the -1 firing penalty counts for those firing into **or** out of **or** through the area of smoke. A tuft of cotton wool denotes smoke nicely on the battlefield. The exposed troops and cover rules all still apply for figures in smoke, it just counts as the equivalent of soft cover. Note: If the troops are already in cover and smoke is discharged on top of this, count the cover as being 1 level higher than it is. No cover can be counted higher than 'reinforced, though. It is permissible for a figure to discharge a smoke round in his own hand to give his firing position some cover. Vehicles do this with smoke canisters. The area of smoke lasts the duration of the game.

INFANTRY GRENADES

Grenade type	Effect	Blast template
High explosive (HE)	Standard damage type- effective against lightly armoured troops	2
Smoke (SMK)	Blocks vision (See below)	2

SUPPORT GRENADES

Grenade type	Effect	Blast template
Armour Piercing (AP)	High damage type- small blast area, but better at taking out PA/ AD troops	1
Anti vehicular (AV), armour piercer	Power damage against vehicles, low damage for any figures in burst area. Bonus of only -1 penalty against AM shields, rather than -3.	1

SPECIALISED GRENADES

Grenade type	Effect	Blast template
Fragmentation HE (FHE)	Standard damage type-large burst area, effective against lightly armoured troops	3
Smoke (SMK)	Blocks vision (See below)	2
Limpet (LPT)	Self tracking once thrown/ fired, this grenade houses a shaped charge, affecting only one figure. +2 hit bonus, Power damage type	1 figure only
Armour Piercing (AP)	High damage type- small blast area, but better at taking out PA/ AD troops	1
Stun (STU)	Stun damage type.	2
Anti vehicular (AV), armour piercer	Power damage type against vehicles, low damage type for any figures in burst area. Bonus of only -1 penalty against PS shields, rather than -3.	1

CARTRIDGE PISTOL, RIOT GUN, GRENADE LAUNCHER, BAZOOKA

These weapons function in the same way as hand thrown grenades, but have much longer ranges. All types fire munitions equivalent to any specialised grenade. These weapons can be used indirectly in conjunction with a support Targetter. You must pay points for the launcher AND ALSO one type of grenade pack (usually specialised).

MISSILE LAUNCHERS

The missile launcher fires an unguided rocket propelled shell to long distances (up to 60 inches), the burst area of the shell is larger than that of hand grenades or grenade launchers. There are several versions available including vehicle mounted and automatic weapons.

MISSILE ROUNDS

Missile type	Effect	Blast template
Anti-personnel (AP)	Large blast area anti- personnel shell. Standard damage type.	4
Anti –tank (AT)	Tank busting high penetration round. Total damage type against vehicles, standard damage type for any figures in burst area. Bonus of only -1 penalty against PS shields, rather than -3.	1

Note: Missile launcher variants may alternatively fire any type of specialised grenade (blast radius identical to grenade being used), but the trooper must have paid points for a specialist grenade pack as well.

ATGW LAUNCHERS

Anti-tank guided weapons fire advanced guided missiles with powerful warheads. 'To- hit' figures are low to represent the guided nature of the munitions. Expensive and powerful. Man- portable and vehicle mounted versions available. See specific examples in the Beamstrike weapons tables, in the charts pack.

SUPPORT TARGETER AND INDIRECT FIRE

A figure who has an indirect fire weapon (see list below), may take one move phase to 'deploy' a support targeter equipped weapon. The deployed support targeter then allows the battlefield to be viewed from the targeter of another comrade within 40 inches.

Indirect fire may be given as follows:

Support targeter must be deployed (takes 1 move phase)

Support firer (figure A) announces which (targeter equipped) figure he is supporting (figure B). Figure B must be within 40 inches of figure A.

The target (figure C) must be within range of the weapons of figures A and B, and B must have line of sight to the target (figure C)

Support firer (A) can fire at C (even if he can't see the target), with an additional -2 firing penalty. This support firing counts as figure A's attack in that fire phase. Figure B may fire his own weapon normally at the same target (figure C).

As you can see the support targeter allows figures with indirect fire weapons like missile and grenade launchers to hang back and give fire support to troops closer in the action, a bit like off table fire support.

INDIRECT FIRE WEAPONS ARE: Thrown grenades, grenade launcher, riot gun, cartridge pistol, bazooka and missile launcher, (Vehicles may also give indirect fire support if they mount any of the weapons above, or a missile salvo, as long as the firing vehicle has a sensor array, or there is a friendly command array equipped vehicle somewhere on the battlefield)

NOTE: An undeployed support targeter equipped indirect weapon CANNOT be fired indirectly but may still be fired at targets where a line of sight exists

DEMOLITIONS

Any weapon may be used in fire against buildings, doors etc, although some are more effective than others. The effect of fire is determined by taking into consideration the power of the weapon and the strength of the target structure: If using these rules where large buildings are in play, sketch simple internal floor plans for each.

Whenever such targets are hit, throw 1d10 and consult the following chart: Note figures with 'sapper' skill add 2 to their dice roll as they will selectively target 'weak' points of the structure.

Explosive weapons (All grenades and missiles) use the column to the right of their actual power level (note that total damage type is the highest damage category) For example a HE grenade (standard power) actually uses the high power chart for demolition effect.

TARGET	WEAPON DAMAGE CLASS (1d10 roll)				
	LOW (Melee class1)	STANDARD (Melee class 2)	HIGH (Melee class 3)	POWER (Melee class 4)	TOTAL
Light door	8	4	3	2	1
Heavy door	10	8	6	3	1
Armoured door	10	10	9	5	3
Standard room	NE	11	7	5	1
Reinforced bunker room	NE	NE	12	9	7
Length of heavy wall	NE	9	8	7	5
Fortress wall	NE	NE	10	9	7

The number in the boxes is that required to demolish the item in question, throw equal to or higher than the number listed. See the effects of demolishing structures, below.
NE: No effect on the structure, no matter how many attacks are made.
For Total 2 weapons, add 1 to the d10 roll, for Total 3 weapons, add 3.

EFFECT OF DEMOLITION

A demolished door falls inwards, allowing access. Rooms or bunkers which are demolished collapse, destroyed. Collapsing rooms have the same effect on occupants as 'standard' hits. Any troops surviving a collapsing room are placed within 1 inch of the nearest outside room wall.
In buildings with multiple rooms, the collapse of one room may weaken the structure sufficiently for others to collapse in a chain reaction. In such buildings, every time a room collapses, throw a 1d6. Roll for EACH adjoining room on that level and the level above (if present). On a roll of 1-2 the next room also collapses and any rooms adjoining that one will now need to be diced for. These rules could result in a building completely being destroyed by the 'domino' effect, after only one room initially being destroyed.
Where the target is a wall of some kind, a demolition causes the wall to collapse 1 inch in each direction from the point of attack. Any figures on top of the wall at the time of collapse get an automatic hit at 'standard' damage type. Survivors are placed within 1 inch of the demolished wall section.

Demolition pack
Must be carried to the site of the demolition, then 1 move phase is taken to set it up, during which time the figure (must have 'sapper' skill) may do nothing else. The sapper may also set up the charge during a fire phase, but if he is hit by a firearm during set up, throw 1d6. 1-4 hits the figure, dice for damage as usual. 5- Demolition pack damaged, unusable. 6- Demolition pack detonates, blast template 1, total damage type.
When set up, the demolition may be triggered by the sapper in any subsequent fire phase. Note that a dead sapper cannot detonate the charge. Use the 'Total' damage column of effect on the demolition for effect on structures.

OFF TABLE FIRE SUPPORT/ LASER PAINTERS

Beamstrike is a squad based infantry combat game and individual pieces of artillery (other than the very lightest), larger spacecraft, sea based warships and attack aircraft are outside the scope of the rules. These fire elements are collectively known as off table fire support, and are represented in the game as 'support modules' costing 15 points each. Each module of fire support may be called on *once per player turn*.

Any figures on the table equipped with a 'Laser painter' may designate any target they have line of sight to, within 40 inches. Laser painting counts as an action, and is done in any fire phase (so firer may designate or fire but not both). Laser painting does not expose concealed troops as firing would, as the designation instrument is silent and simply 'paints' the target for lock-on of the advanced artillery/ vehicular/ starship targeting systems.

The designator may call upon as many fire support modules as wished (up to the maximum number available), throw a 1d6 for each:

- Designating trooper part of a squad without a leader figure: 6 needed for a successful strike.
- Designating trooper has leader/ scout in squad: 5-6 needed for strike.
- Designating figure IS a leader/ hero/scout: 4-6 needed for a strike.
- Command vehicle is in play on table: 3-6 needed for a strike.

Successful fire support strikes allow the placing of any grenade or missile blast template on the painted target immediately.
A failure to call support still 'uses' up one module, but means the message was not received properly, or the painting signal was not locked, or the support modules were busy elsewhere. Note that support requests from leaders or heroes, or where a leader is near, are more likely to be granted.

Example: An Isolate scout laser paints an enemy troop convoy. There are 5 modules of off table fire support available to the army, but another figure has already unsuccessfully tried to call on 3 of them. The scout is within 40 inches of the target, has line of sight, and instead of firing small arms , designates (he is equipped with a laser painter device) The scout needs to throw 4- 6 to successfully call a strike. He throws a 2 and a 6, meaning 1 module is successfully called, and one fails. He decides the call was for an anti-personnel missile and places the template over the figure which was designated.

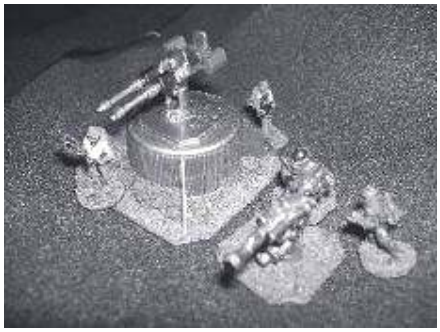
Note: ANY figure, vehicle or building may be designated for off table fire support, the size of the target is irrelevant, it is the pinpointed location on the surface of the planet that is communicated by the painting instrument, and the rank/ communication ability of the individual which determines the success of the strike. Note also that off table fire support cannot be destroyed as such, but by removing any figures with laser painters, you remove the threat of off table fire support.

ON TABLE FIRE SUPPORT

On table fire support is divided into 4 categories, squad support weapons, indirect fire support weapons, light standing turrets and light artillery. Squad support weapons are listed on the Squad Support Weapon list. They function in the same way as other weapons table direct fire weapons and need no further explanation here. Indirect fire weapons are the hand grenade, grenade and missile launcher, riot gun, bazooka and cartridge pistol and again have already been dealt with.

LIGHT STANDING TURRET WEAPONS (Stationary AI-turrets)
Standing turrets can be used to defend positions, guard valuable objects, or boost firepower at critical points. Standing turret weapons have several common features:

They stand around 10 foot tall, cannot be moved during combat (are positioned by the owner before the battle starts), count as a stationary power armoured individual for damage purposes. They have 360° arc of fire, are computer controlled (bonus to use is as if troop using targeter), 'regular' troop category. They are basically computer controlled, immobile artificial intelligence turrets.
Basic points cost per turret is: 20 plus the point cost of weapon installed.
(Up to 3 infantry, squad support, or heavy weapons may be installed in each. See the weapons section for a couple of examples)
When hit, an NE or Glancing Hit result has no effect, a Kill result destroys the turret.
Note turrets are placed in position before play begins and may not be moved once placed.



LIGHT ARTILLERY
Light artillery can be turret mounted, robo- mounted or stand alone (typically grav-lifter mounted).
Light artillery may be any weapon listed in the tank armament chart.

Turret mounted guns may mount any size 3 gun or less, and are computer controlled, having 360° arc of fire. They are identical to the light turret weapons listed above, but count as assault dreadnought armoured troops for hit purposes.
Basic cost of a turret is 25 plus the cost of the tank weapon installed.

Robo- mounted guns are attached to a heavy combat robot, removing the fragile 'human' element, and allowing some degree of mobility. Robo- artillery may mount either up to 4 linked forward firing heavy weapons (chosen from heavy weapon list), or any gun from the tank gun chart up to size 3. The Robo- artillery unit must not move the phase before it fires any tank gun. Firing heavy weapons may be done while moving. Robo- artillerists are assumed to have 'gunner' skill as part of their programming. Note that a lighter version of this robot, the robo- support is available, see robot section.

Tripod mounted guns may be any size 3 or less tank gun, and require 2 troops, one gunner to aim and fire the weapon, and one as a spotter/ loader.
Tripod mounted guns count as light armoured infantry for target purposes, any kill result destroys the gun, a miss or glancing hit has no effect. Tripod mounted guns may be moved as follows:
It takes one move phase to 'pack up' the gun (by its two crew). In the next move phase, the crew (carrying the gun and ammo, usually with the help of anti-grav propulsers) may move as per power armoured infantry (even though they are fast infantry)
At the new set up position, it takes one movement phase to deploy the artillery (it may not fire unless deployed first).
Basic cost of tripod mounted artillery is 5 plus the cost of the tank weapon installed, plus the cost of two regular fast infantry gunners with laser pistols (which is 8 points each).
When tripod weapons are fired upon, either the gun itself (counts as light armoured infantry), or the gunners may be chosen as a target. If the weapons crew is killed, the gun remains until either captured by the enemy, or friendly troops get to it. Non- gunner troops operating light artillery may do so at a -2 penalty to hit.

COVER AND CONCEALMENT

Leaving your troops out in the open with no cover is very foolish and your army will quickly be whittled down. Wise commanders make use of every possible piece of cover available and consider squad movements in relation to lines of sight of enemy troops, and the foot movement/ jump capability of their troops. See section 4 of the rules, especially obstacles and scenery. There are 5 levels of cover in a Beamstrike game as follows:

COVER AND CONCEALMENT CHART

Type of cover	Examples	Hit penalty	Concealment Range- figures	Concealment Range- Vehicles
NONE	Desert, road, large flat featureless terrain	None	40 inches (30)	As far as line of sight exists
SOFT	Scrub, bush land, light woods, crops, foliage	-1	10 inches (7)	18 inches
HARD	Buildings, low walls, heavy woods/ jungle, in crater, in trench, sandbags, behind vehicle	-2	6 inches (4)	8 inches
REINFORCED	Bunkers, in armoured vehicles	-4	4 inches (3)	6 inches
ABSOLUTE	No line of sight, behind high wall etc	Cannot fire upon	2 inches	4 inches

NOTE: Concealment ranges in brackets are if the concealed troops have 'scout' skill.

HIT PENALTY

This is the penalty enemy troops have to their dice roll to hit if they fire on your element hidden by the various types of cover.

CONCEALED TROOPS

Troops or vehicles which are in at least soft cover and did not move in the last movement phase are considered concealed. Place a conceal marker next to the squad or vehicle. (Note by not moving in the previous move phase, troops may become concealed and deployed in the same phase). Concealed troops *may not be fired at by their opponent* unless they expose themselves by firing, moving, or are picked up by biological energy sensors.

FIRST SHOTS

Before each fire phase, both players announce which of their concealed units are going to fire. Such troops get a special 'first shot'. This means that when they fire, the casualties they cause are removed from play immediately and have no chance of return fire. If important, the order of 'first shots' is as follows: All phasing players forces fire first, then the other players forces may fire, in order of troop training level. Once all first shots are dealt with, remove the concealed counter from those units and the fire phase goes on as usual. The troops who were concealed, but have now fired become eligible targets for other enemy units in a position to fire on them.

First shots do not necessarily give away your position permanently- if you choose not to fire an immobile unit in the next fire phase, that unit is concealed again and cannot be fired upon (place a 'conceal' counter back with the unit).

CONCEALED TROOPS IN BUILDINGS

If troops are within buildings, although the enemy army cannot fire on the troops individually, it is permissible to target the building they are in with any weapon including off table fire support, with the aim of causing casualties by demolition of the building. This is to simulate the situation where troops were seen entering hard cover/ buildings and area/ suppressive fire is being poured into that area. This is NOT allowed if the troops were concealed from the start of the game and never moved or fired (as the enemy just doesn't know they are there!)

CONCEALMENT RANGE

Battlefield troops are usually equipped with various sorts of biological energy sensors, including infra-red, motion detectors, thermal imagers and the good old human eyeball, allowing fire on troops which are concealed if the range is close enough.

Regardless of whether a unit is concealed, they can be fired upon at the ranges listed on the cover and concealment chart, in the concealment range columns, as long as a line of sight to the unit exists.

WOODS

Due to the abundance of soft and hard cover and camouflaging foliage, troops may not fire through a wood further than 4 inches at figures, or 12 inches at vehicle or building targets.

Examples: A tactical unit is 5 inches inside a wooded area on patrol for terrorist elements. The terrorist group of foot soldiers moves past, just outside of the woods. The unit in the woods cannot fire out, or be fired upon by the enemy.

Two opposed units approach each other inside a wooded area. Although they will be aware of each others presence at 12 inches (soft cover concealment range), they cannot fire at each other until they are just 4 inches apart- Let the close combat melee commence!

LINE OF SIGHT AND COVER

Occasionally determining what type of cover a figure has can be difficult, because although a figure may not be next to a piece of cover, when the line of sight from the firer to target is visualized, cover elements may partially obscure the target. In these cases, the cover penalty for the firer is still applicable.

Cover may protect figures from fire in one direction, but not provide protection from fire from another direction. An example would be troops behind a sandbagged wall. Enemy troops firing from the front would get the hard cover penalty, but if the enemy sneaked a few troops round behind the sandbags, the sandbagged figures would get no cover bonus!

CLOSE COMBAT PHASE

The close combat phase of the game turn gives forces in close contact another chance to act. When a member of a squad/ unit comes within 2 inches of another unit, both entire units are considered in 'close combat'. Note that some figures in each unit will be further apart than 2 inches at this point, but the entire unit is still in 'close combat'. Each member of the phasing players squad makes a troop roll. Figures succeeding their troop roll are allowed a further action, chosen from the table below (You may choose the action or roll randomly). **Note that members of a unit containing a Leader get a +1 bonus to the troop roll.**

CLOSE COMBAT ACTIONS TABLE

1D6 random (if needed)	C.C. ACTION	Notes
1-2	Fire close assault weapon*	*Any pistol, auto laser, shotgun, SMG, palm flamer.
3-4	Move up to 2 inches	This may include moving over obstacles, through an unlocked door etc, engaging into hand to hand combat. Squad formation/ coherency must be maintained
5-6	Throw a grenade	Bear in mind blast radius!

CASUALTIES IN CLOSE COMBAT

Note that when close combat weapons (e.g.: SMG) are fired, or grenades thrown in close combat, resolve the hit and hit effect as normally, but if the defending players figure is killed it is removed from play immediately, there is no return fire.

CLOSE COMBAT NOTES:

Some systems do not allow firing into squads in close combat, but the Beamstrike rules mean that the close combat phase should resolve all close combat and hand to hand actions; the following move phase will give the opponent chance to move away from close combat, or to engage closer. Other squads may fire at units at close quarters with opponents, but must bear in mind that weapons with blast templates may well hit friend and foe, and their use is potentially dangerous.

HAND TO HAND COMBAT

When figures come in base to base contact (1/2 inch apart or less), hand to hand (melee) combat ensues. The outcome of any hand to hand combat is resolved immediately if in close combat, or otherwise at the end of that movement phase, there is no waiting until the next available fire phase. In Beamstrike hand to hand combat is deadly, and one or other of the combatants will not see the next phase! Both players throw a 1d10 for each trooper in melee combat, adding or subtracting the following modifiers to the roll:

HAND TO HAND COMBAT THROW MODIFIERS

Hero	+3	Doper	-2	Hibevor/ Grey	-2
Elite	+2	Fast infantry	-0-	Growwlan/ Spug	+1
Veteran	+1	Light armour infantry	+2	Warbird	+5
Regular	-0-	Power armour infantry	+5	Ferrapur	+2
Robot or android	-2	Assault Dreadnought infantry	+6	Centaling	+3
Civilian	-2	No melee weapon/ unarmed	-3	Thuntra	+5
On higher ground	+2				
Swordsman	+4	Each opponent above 1	-3	Melee weapon carried	See list below for modifier
Just had glancing hit	-2				

Note that all modifiers are cumulative. E.g.: Elite hero in power armour with power glove (+2,+3,+5,+3)= +13 to 1d10 throw. Ambidextrous heroes using 2 melee weapons may dice for each one, taking the highest score.

Melee Weapon list

As Beamstrike is a mass combat game, the only differentiation of the items listed below is the points cost, melee combat bonus and any special weapon capabilities. Note weapon listings are for the Imperial Era and other Eras may have other melee weapons available, or have some items prohibited. See the specific Era supplement you are using for more details.

Item	Point cost	Melee bonus	Special capability	HtH'v' vehicle	notes
Unarmed/ no melee weapon	**0**	**-3**	-	**1**	Civilians, prisoners etc.
Gun butt	**0**	**-1**	-	**1**	The figure must be carrying an infantry weapon
Steel Sword/ knife/ axe/ club or Vibro knife/ rifle bayonet	**1**	**0**	-	**2**	-
Vibro or Monomolecular sword/ Axe	**1.5***	**+1**	-	**2**	-
Force or power sword	**2**	**+3**	-	**3**	-
Riot Stick	**2**	**+3**	Kill=STUN	**3**	-
Power glove	**2**	**+3**	-	**3**	-
Advanced force sword	**3**	**+4**	-	**3**	ONLY Ferrapur,Centaling and Spug may use this.
Imperial Warhammer	**3**	**+4**	2 handed, so counts as figures main weapon	**3**	Only Imperial forces may use.
Imperial Warsword	**4**	**+4**	2 handed, so counts as figures main weapon	**4**	Massive sword. Imperial only
Power Axe	**5**	**+5**	-	**4**	-
Crimson Rebel Power Glaive	**5**	**+5**	2 handed, so counts as figures main weapon	**4**	Only CR forces may use.
Heavy Power axe	**7**	**+5**	-	**4**	Thuntra only.
Pirate Multiblades	**6**	**+3**	2 handed, so counts as figures main weapon May throw 2d10 in combat and use the highest roll.	**3**	Powered multi bladed melee weapon, used 2 handed. Must have swordsman skill to use. Pirates only!
Light Sword (10,000 year war era and above ONLY)	**10**	**+8**	Must have swordsman skill to use.	**4**	Only Elite/ hero may use. Counts as main weapon

*Costs 1 point for 1 item, but if more than one figure is allocated this item, calculate total points for unit with a points cost of 1.5. For example, 4 figures carrying Vibro swords would cost 6 points.

The total score for each combatant is noted. If the attackers score is equal to or lower than the defenders score, the attacker is removed from play. If the attackers score is higher than the defenders, the defender is removed from play.
Note if you move into hand to hand combat during the move phase, after the combat is resolved, you may not move further if you had moved less than that figures maximum move allowance for that turn. The players whose turn it is, is always considered to be the 'attacker'. Note figures with digimedics may make a saving throw to avoid being killed, and if successful, the figure is assumed unhurt. Killed figures may not be helped by a medic.

Note: HtH versus vehicle column refers to the demolition table for use when individuals with Melee weapons try to attack buildings or structures, and the table below for Turrets/ vehicle attacks.1= First column, 2= second column etc.

Melee weapons and doors.
If a figure armed with a Melee weapon tries to knock down a locked door to gain entry (See demolitions rules) check the HtH v vehicle class in the above table. 1=LOW damage class, 2= Standard damage class, 3= High damage class and 4=Power damage class.

HAND TO HAND COMBAT WITH MULTIPLE ATTACKERS

Each figure may only engage in one round of hand to hand combat in a particular phase. It is permissible to place up to 4 attacking figures around a defending enemy to engage in hand to hand combat, as long as all attackers have sufficient movement allowance to move in base to base contact with the defender, and can be arranged in the configuration of one figure per side (one in front, one behind and one to each side). All figures roll their 1d10 (+/- modifiers), and each attacker must have rolled higher than the defending figure (who has extra penalties for fighting off more than 1 opponent) or face being killed.

Example of one on one combat:
An Imperialist shock trooper attacks a Crimson Rebel figure. The Imperial is a sword armed elite so adds 2 to his d10 throw. The Crimson rebel is in power armour so adds 5. Imperial troop throws 8 making his total score10. The rebel throws 5 also making his total score 10. As this is a draw and the Imperial shock troop was attacking, the rebel wins and the Imperial is removed from play.

Example of 3 on one combat:
During blacks movement phase, he has sufficient movement to move 3 of his Fast Infantry with power swords around Whites Assault Dreadnought armoured elite trooper with power glove. He places one figure in front and one to each side of whites. Blacks figures roll the dice, adding modifiers and get totals of 6, 9 and 11. Whites Assault Dreadnought scores a total of 10. Black removes 2 of his figures, along with whites dreadnought- The defending dreadnought had taken 2 enemies down with him!

Hand to Hand combat with Turrets/ Vehicles

If troops come into base contact with a vehicle or turret, they may in some circumstances initiate melee combat with the object. Use the table below to determine circumstance/ outcome:

Troops in base contact with……	Melee weapon class 'v' vehicles			
	1 **E.g: Unarmed**	**2** **E.g: Knife, sword, club**	**3** **E.g: Power/ force sword, glove**	**4** **E.g: Power Glaive/ Hvy power axe.**
Light turret	NE	NE	KO	KO
Light artillery	NE	NE	Melee	KO
Moving vehicle hull 0-2	NE	NE	Melee	Melee
Stationary vehicle hull 0-2	NE	Melee	Melee	KO
Moving vehicle hull 3+	NE	NE	NE	Melee
Stationary vehicle hull 3+	NE	NE	Melee	Melee

NE: No effect. Troops cannot harm a turret or vehicle with this melee weapon.
MELEE: Make Hand to Hand combat rolls (1d10) as normal, the turret/ vehicle counts as being unarmed, the armour level of Turrets and Artillery is listed on pages 22 and 23 of the core rules. For vehicles, hull size 0 vehicles have a +0 HtH bonus, Hull size 1-5 is +3 per Hull size (So hull size 3 vehicle has a +9 to its HtH 1d10 roll). If the attackers win, vehicle takes 1 penetrating hit (no matter how many attackers win that round of hand to hand combat), if vehicle wins, there is no effect (Attackers are NOT killed).
KO: Troops in base to base contact with object can automatically destroy it. Power/ force weapons can simply cut barrels off, or destroy the turrets targeting system.
Note: Only wheeled, tracked and STATIONARY grav/ hover vehicles can be melee attacked. Moving Grav/ hover vehicles cannot be attacked in this way.

Riot sticks/ unarmed combat

Figures who win a hand to hand combat bout with a riot stick, or who are unarmed get a 'stun' result instead of a kill. This means that a stun counter is placed next to the loser and that figure may not now do anything for 3 turns unless a 6 is rolled on a 1d6 (throw once per turn). A stunned figure, if attacked by another figure with a melee weapon or firearm is automatically slain.

Morale and Leadership

Morale rules within war games are created to simulate what would happen to a real army if it lost a substantial percentage of its troops, as very few units would continue the carnage down to the very last man (Rebel factions not included!), as realistically, a broken army would initiate an organised retreat, intent on saving further casualties and getting its remaining forces out of there to fight another day. In one-off fights it can be hard for players to understand why its last few brave figures will retreat, when they were so close to victory, but if you were on the ground, under gyrobolt gun attack, with Assault Dreadnought armoured troops closing in on your position, perhaps you would feel differently! Note also see 'suppression' rules section, with weapon deployment.
At the beginning of a game, calculate your army's starting morale strength by adding points for each element as follows:

Element	Points	Element	Points	Element	Points
Each trooper	1	Each armoured vehicle or hero	3	Each nominated building/ key defence position/ VIP civilian or unarmoured vehicle	5-20 (Agree before battle)

- A figure counts as lost if he is killed.
- Medics never count as lost if killed, but do add to an army's morale strength at the beginning of the game. This is because friendly troops are infuriated, not demoralised, if a medic is targeted.
- An armoured vehicle is counted as 'lost' for morale purposes if it is 'knocked out'. It is still in the game (no morale loss) if it is only immobilized or has its weapons knocked out, or has lost its crew.

Once the starting morale strength has been calculated make a note of this figure, along with the half morale strength value (round fractions up) on the battle sequence monitor sheet at the end of these rules. At the end of each fire phase (and occasionally at each close combat phase), adjust the current morale strength.
When morale point losses come to half of the original total, the army's' morale is 'shaken'

SHAKEN ARMY (place shaken counter next to army)
When an army is 'shaken' it may not advance, but may hold its ground or start to retreat, it may fire upon eligible targets as wished.
A shaken army must make a morale test at the end of each 'own' player turn. To do this, throw 2d6. If the score is 7 or more, the army is 'broken'.

BROKEN ARMY (Place broken counter next to army)
A broken army must retreat all troops and vehicles their maximum movement distance in at least 1 move phase per turn, except those rallied by leaders, or fanatics or robots. In the other move phase, it may stand its ground but cannot advance. A broken army also may not engage any targets other than those who have fired upon them in the same turn, or those that block off the army's retreat

NOMINATED BUILDINGS/ KEY POSITIONS
Before the game commences, an independent spectator may nominate, or the players mutually agree key scenery or terrain features/ positions which are allocated a morale value. This can include key bunkers, a bridge, a checkpoint, a fuel dump, or other important position. These are added to the morale strength as normal, and treated as lost if destroyed by demolition, or captured by the enemy (i.e. the defenders are all killed). The morale value for the item is then added to the other players' morale strength. If captured back, the morale value then passes back to the original player. In this way it is possible for an army to be shaken by the loss of such a position, but then stop being shaken if it is recaptured. A broken army is broken; it is too late to do anything by that time, unless the troops are rallied by leaders. In certain game scenarios, even civilians may be assigned a morale value in the game, if the objective of one side is to rescue/ kidnap them.

Arc of facing while retreating
When units are retreating they may retreat on foot, but still be facing forward, this means they may fire back at troops who are still attacking them. The exception is vehicles which when retreating turn around (and may only fire back into the battle with turreted or rear facing weapons), and troops which have jump packs, they must turn to 'jump' back, thus exposing their backs to enemy fire. Retreating troops do not have to follow squad coherency rules, and must make for the 'friendly' table edge they came from. In games where troops started in the centre of the table, they retreat as close to the central part of the table as possible.

SUPPRESSION AND MORALE
In a game of Beamstrike, suppression applies to an individual squad, or single independently acting figure whereas morale rules apply to the whole army.

LEADERSHIP AND RALLYING TROOPS

Each army must purchase at least one figure with leadership skill to act as the duty officer in that engagement. Often players may well wish to purchase many more, often around one per squad (See troop characteristics for more information on leaders). The moment an army is 'broken' and starts to retreat, all leaders present may attempt to rally remaining troops around them. For each leader roll 1d6, and the score is the number of troops the leader has rallied and who will stay with him. Heroes may also rally troops and roll 1d6. Heroes with leadership skill may roll 2d6, taking the highest figure (not adding the dice together). Troops must be within 8 inches of the leader when the rally roll is made, or they are too far away to be rallied. The rallied troops may fire and move as normal, and do not have to retreat with the rest of the army. The rallied troops now count as a new unit/ squad for coherency purposes, even though they may have come from different original infantry elements.
Leader figures may be assigned to each squad for greatest effect, or a separate 'command' squad may be created containing the leader figure.

Fanatic troops/ robots
Morale rules do not apply to fanatic troops and robots. Any fanatic human troops which were not fired upon in the last fire phase must move straight towards the nearest enemy unless they are in a coherent squad containing a leader, or another leader/ hero figure is within 8 inches. The advance must be directly towards the nearest visible enemy, if no enemy is visible fanatic troops advance towards the enemy table edge.

Reinforcements

Reinforcements are extra units sent to strengthen a military force or aid in the performance of its mission. Dependant on the scenario (and agreed before the game commences), a proportion of an armys troops/ vehicles may be held in 'reinforcement'. Troops held for reinforcements are not placed at the start of the game, but are held off- table until they are called. Units allocated as reinforcements only cost 80% of the points value of regular units. (For example a tank is going to be used as a reinforcement, it usually costs 100 points, so now it only costs 80 points) Reinforcements may be introduced in several ways:

Q- Travel pod. (See Q- pod section), cost 30 points per pod)
Placed anywhere on the battlefield before troops are placed (bear in mind the travel pods can be destroyed by enemy troops). Each Q-travel pod can transport up to 5 figures of any troop class or a light vehicle (vehicles up to hull class 2), in each movement phase. Note that as troops must move into or out of a Q- travel pod, the bay can only in fact be used in one move phase per player turn so it spends the other waiting for troops to enter or clear the pod. Troops may freely move from 'reinforcement' status into any Q- pod in any movement phase, no dice roll is needed. They may then fire from the Q- pod in the fire phase and move off the pod in the next friendly move phase. Troops may move from one pod to any other on the table. In evacuation scenarios, troops move into a Q-pod, and in the next move phase are teleported safely to a waiting starship.

The high points cost of Q- travel pods includes the orbital craft support and control mechanisms. A Q-travel pod is destroyed on any 'KILL' result from ranged fire, and counts as a stationary assault dreadnought armoured troop for armour purposes. Glancing hit results have no effect. Q- travel pods may be inactivated by any trooper in base to base contact armed with a power or a force weapon.

Ground based. (no extra points cost)
Reinforcements may enter the battlefield from the friendly table edge. To call in a reinforcing unit, a 1d6 roll can be made during each friendly movement phase for each squad/ vehicle/ independent figure The dice roll needed to succeed is the same as that for calling in off- table fire support (for example, a leader needs to roll a 4-6 for success). A laser painter device is NOT needed to call a reinforcement. Units successfully called are placed within 2 inches of the friendly table edge in that movement phase, they may not move further in this movement phase. Thereafter they may fire and move as normal.

Point drop- ship (Costs 20 points per ship available)
A hull class 5 drop ship with the capacity to drop 24 FI troops (See rules on troop capacity and armour type) or a hull class 2 or 3 vehicle, or 2 hull class 1 vehicles, or 3 hull class 0 vehicles into action. The 'point' drop ship will only drop troops anywhere on the table then immediately leave, it may not fire or take any further part in the action, it is there solely to drop troops off.
To call in a drop ship, a 1d6 role can be made during each friendly movement phase for each point drop ship available. The dice roll needed to succeed is the same as that for calling in off- table fire support (for example, a leader needs to roll a 4-6 for success). A laser painter device is NOT needed to call a drop- ship.
Drop ships successfully called in a movement phase are placed in a 'landed' position on the field, in the next friendly move phase, troops may disembark and are placed within 1 inch of the ship. In the next friendly move phase, the ship takes off and leaves the battlefield. Note that there should be one fire phase within all of this allowing the enemy to shoot at incoming/ landed drop ships. This is allowed, the vehicle hits tables are used normally (vehicle is classed as airborne),and your reinforcing troops are classed as being onboard passengers, so if the drop ship is destroyed, goodbye reinforcements. Destroyed/ disabled dropships cannot be used again but do not count towards morale. Drop ships which have just left the battlefield may be called back again in the next friendly movement phase. In evacuation scenarios, troops may move into a point drop ship, and in the next move phase are transported safely to a waiting starship.

Note also that existing troops can be moved around the battlefield in ground based vehicles, or in drop-ship type aircraft which have been purchased for continual use in the game (rather than point drop- ships).

Reinforcements and morale

See morale rules. Only units in play on the battlefield count towards morale, reinforcements are only added to the morale total when they come onto the table. Care is needed as a battle may be lost before reinforcements arrive on the scene! If an existing army is 'shaken' you may still attempt to reinforce and if successful, the extra morale points added from reinforcements arriving may take your army total morale points above the half value again, meaning the army is no longer shaken.
If your army is 'broken' adding reinforcements at this point does not alter the morale status of the existing force, they must still retreat as in the core rules. However, any reinforcements called in the next turn after an army becomes 'broken' may be added to any 'rallied' troops (See leadership and rallying troops), if they appear on the table edge within 8 inches of a leader who has just rallied. Unrallied reinforcements, or those still off table are considered lost after an army is broken.

ANDROIDS AND ROBOTS IN BATTLE

The use of androids and robots on the future battlefield is common place. Often built stronger than mere flesh, and hard wired to ignore the effects of suppression and morale they make excellent warriors. Variants include massive walking artillery support bots, to stealthy assassin droids, to maintenance and technical robots. The downside to using these units are their relative lack of close combat ability and unpredictability if hit.. Robots and androids are moved in the same way as living troops, ranged combat is treated normally if the robot or android is fitted with firearms

RULES SPECIFIC TO ROBOTS

- -2 penalty to Hand to hand combat roll, often have inferior movement capability compared to humans.
- Each time the robot has a glancing hit result (in other words was hit but not 'killed'), roll 1d6. On a result of a 5 or 6, the robot has a malfunction
- May not call off table fire support or reinforcements.
- Robots **may not** be classed as heroes, but may be assigned skills including fanatic.

RULES SPECIFIC TO ANDROIDS

- -2 penalty to Hand to hand combat roll
- May not call off table fire support or reinforcements.
- Androids **may not** be classed as heroes, but may be assigned skills including fanatic.
- Androids may NOT mount personal shields, as they interfere with their positronic brains

Robots and Androids may be assigned with fanatic skill and ignore morale rules and fight to the bitter end as per their programming, but do not advance automatically. Robots and androids ignore Suppression rules.

MALFUNCTIONS

Place a malfunction marker next to the robot in question, At the end of the firing phase, after all other attacks have been resolved, roll 1d6 for each malfunctioning robot and consult the table below:

Dice score	Result
1-3	Does not fire in next fire phase (essentially as glancing hit)
4	Fires at nearest enemy (resolve in this fire phase)
5	Fires at nearest building, vehicle or flying vehicle (in that order), whether friendly or enemy. (resolve in this fire phase)
6	Fires at nearest figure, vehicle, flying vehicle, support weapon, or occupied building (in that order) whether friendly or enemy. (resolve in this fire phase)

In the movement phase, roll 2d6 If the score is less than 6, the robot does not move in that movement phase, if the score is 6 or above the robot moves in the direction indicated on the diagram below:

At the end of each players own turn end, roll a 1d6 for each malfunctioning robot. A roll of 1-3 means the robot continues to malfunction, a roll of 4 means the robot shuts down and is removed from play and considered killed for morale purposes, a roll of 5 or 6 restores the robot to full operation.

EXAMPLE ROBOTS AND DROIDS

The following table gives Beamstrike points values for robots and androids.

Note the total points cost per figure may vary slightly from the equivalent human value with the same weapons, this takes into account movement rate of robot, any skills or built in equipment, or special weapon pods which may increase/ decrease their combat effectiveness.

Arm weapon packs or linked chest/ body weapons are treated just like multiple weapon packs on PA or AD troops, i.e. must fire at same target etc….Only one weapon pack is usually fired per fire phase, unless second pack contains hand flamers .

- **NAME:** Robot or Android name
- **AND OR ROB**: This means is it an android or a robot (Malfunctions apply only to Robots)
- **POINTS:** Game points cost per robot, note that you may need to spend additional points on armaments.
- **MODEL AVAILABLE:** Any metal miniature available commercially to represent this robot.
- **TRAINING:** The troop training class of the robot.
- **MOVE CLASS**: The equivalent standard troop type this figure moves as.
- **ARMAMENT/ ACCESSORIES INCLUDED:** Lists any weapons, equipment or other items the robot is usually equipped with and is included in the points cost per figure.
- **ARMOUR CLASS**: Construction equivalent of robot, used if hit to determine damage.
- **FURTHER NOTES:** Any further information applicable to the robot or Android.

EXAMPLE BEAMSTRIKE ROBOTS

Name	And or Rob	POINTS per figure	Armour class	Model availability	Training	Move class	Armament/ accessories included in points cost	Further notes
Imperial hvy Battle droid	R	37	PA	15mm.co.uk, laserburn 311	VET	DA	Support bolter, Targetter, fanatic	Slower moving, but hardy in combat. Near miss results have no effect.
Security Robot	R	19	FI	15mm.co.uk, laserburn 600, 601, 602	VET	PA	Squad Hvy laser, Targetter	Slower moving, but hardy in combat.
Robo- Artillery	R	55 Plus cost of guns	Hull class 2 legged vehicle variant	GZG guncrab variants,	REG	AD	May mount any 4 linked Heavy weapons or a single tank gun up to size 3. Support Targetter	Heavy robot able to mount large guns and negate the need for artillery crews. Must halt to fire weapons.
Robo- support	R	38 Plus cost of guns	AD	15mm.co.uk, laserburn 311	REG	AD	May mount up to 2 squad support weapons, both are fired at the same target. Support Targetter.	Squad back up robot with capability to carry support weapons
Medical droid	A	15	LA	15mm.co.uk, laserburn 600, 601, 602	REG	LA	No weapons mounted.	Moves around independently, has medical aid skill.
Cyborg Dog	A	13	FI	15mm.co.uk, Laserburn 118 Guard dog	REG	As antigrav, no penalty for turning	Jaw as powerglove Fanatic, penalty of -2 to hit. Used by Scout and Colonial Police dog handler units. Dog handler's armed with grenade launchers and support targeters keyed to their Cyborg dogs; so dog handler's can use Cyborg dogs line of sight to fire at indirect targets	
Robo- Scout	A	40	PA	GZG SG15-A3	REG	LA	Laser rifle, laser painter, jet pack	Fast moving reconnaissance droid
Scout pod	R	20	LA	15mm.co.uk, HOF45 Robot Scout Drones	REG	FI	Laser painter, laser pistol.	Small scout unit
Sentry Robot	R	29	PA	15mm.co.uk HOF43 Armoured Sentry Robot	REG	AD	Heavy laser built into its eye. Energy shield	Cubist style body and single cyclopic eye. This Sentry is perfect for guard duty or environmental hazard situations with its thick armour.

Background notes on Robots and Androids

A major differentiation which must be made is the difference between a robot and an android. A robot is a mechanical machine which follows instructions from a computer program or a hard wired set of values. It has no capacity to think for itself or operate outside its program (unless damaged!)

Robots are in use throughout the Galaxy in many roles, from menial tasks, now deemed too boring for sentient life, or in situations where the precision/ toughness or strength of mechanical limbs is superior to that of the controlling race. A fearsome use of robots is in combat and War, where the lack of fear or any thoughts of self preservation makes robots the ideal battlefield soldiers of the future.

An android is capable of sentient thought and making its own decisions. The androids basic functions and initial brain programming will influence its behavior to a great deal.

Androids are viewed with some suspicion by many of the population. Perhaps this is due to memories of the Great Droid War (See below), the fact that many are superior to humans, or are in positions of power, or just a superstitious fear of 'synthetic' people.

The Great Droid War

Around the time of the Imperiums greatest control of the core Sol worlds, problems were growing with the increasing numbers of Androids in use throughout these inner most worlds. Sentient artificial life forms were being built with a real capacity for independent thought, and then used for menial or boring work, or used in dangerous situations (War, mining, work in highly radioactive areas etc). It started slowly at first, but a groundswell of bitterness was welling up within many Androids, who although had behavioral inhibitors to prevent unprovoked attacks on biological life forms, were nevertheless fed up with their lot in life.

A small minority, however, had their behavior inhibitors removed and were free to act independently. The Great Droid War lasted some 7 years, during which time thousands of robots and lower droids were built and programmed for destruction and War.

HEROES AND CHARACTERS

Heroes (or the Evil counterpart, villains) are particularly capable or famous individuals. On the battlefield, well placed and commanded heroes can turn the tide of a battle, and boost morale and troop performance, some are very deadly in combat, cutting a swathe through enemy ranks, leaving a pile of broken bodies in their wake. Heroes may fire a pistol (including palm flamers) in each hand at the *same* target. Heroes with ambidexterity skill may fire each pistol weapon at a *differen*t target. Heroes with ambidexterity skill and constitution skill may fire any infantry weapon table weapon from each hand at different targets.
Heroes are expensive (20 points), so think carefully before buying too many, they are still individual figures who can be killed. For more information on heroes, see the troop training level section.

CONSTRUCTING HEROES

Heroes cost a base of 20 points each, may be male, female, or cyborg and have several bonuses and advantages throughout the rule system. (e.g.+3 hand to hand combat rolls, 2+ to succeed troop roll etc). They can be considered as a troop training class above elite.
Each hero also has a base +3 bonus to hit with ranged fire. Ranged fire may be upgraded by paying an additional 2 points per +1 bonus up to a maximum of +6 (which would cost an additional 6 points).

Each hero now gets 3 abilities rolled from the chart below. Each ability has one skill level, so if you roll the same skill twice, just roll the dice again until another is indicated. Additional skills may be selectively 'purchased', the cost being shown below next to the skill name. No hero may have more than 6 special abilities, so choose and roll wisely! Note that hero abilities are NOT available to other troops for purchase, but that all regular troop abilities are available to heroes.

HERO ABILITY TABLE, THROW 1d100

1d100 Dice Roll	Skill/ cost	Description
1-5	**Gun skill (3)**	Adds 3 to hit dice for one nominated weapon.
6-10	**Scout (3)**	May act as a scout in the game
11-15	**Quick fire (2)**	May fire an extra shot at each target
16-18	**Ambidextrous (5)**	Can carry and use 2 hand to hand weapons, and fire at 2 different targets.
19-20	**Sapper (2)**	May act as a sapper in the game
21-25	**Artillerist (1)**	May act as a gunner in the game
26-30	**Initiative (2)**	May roll twice to act in close combat.
31-35	**Aggressive (1)**	May throw for close combat options for enemy within 4 inches(not 2 ins)
36-40	**Leadership (8)**	May act as a leader in the game
41-45	**Medical (3)**	May act as a medic in the game
46-50	**Nerves of steel (2)**	May ignore glancing hit results
51-55	**Fortune (4)**	If you suffer a 'kill' damage result, throw a 1d6. On a 5 or 6, this is downgraded to a glancing hit instead.
56-60	**Dodge (1)**	Twice during a battle you can say you are going to dodge a shot before the hit dice are thrown. Subtract 3 from the firers dice score to hit you.
61-65	**Constitution (5)**	Attacks on hero have -1 penalty when rolling 1d6 for damage
66-70	**Swordsman (3)**	May add an additional 4 to the d10 dice throw in hand to hand combat.
71-75	**Marksman (4)**	Figure adds 2 to his hit dice throws
76-80	**Sharpshooter (5)**	Figure rolls an extra 1d4 as well as the 2d6 when firing.
81-85	**Grenadier(2)**	Add 2 to your hit dice when throwing grenades, or using indirect fire weapons
86-90	**Agile (3)**	May move twice the normal amount in either move phase, but not both.
91-95	**Martial Arts (4)**	Roll an additional D10 in Hand-to-Hand combat – take the highest roll
96-98	**Sniper(3)**	May act as a sniper in the game.
99-100	**Intuitive**	Immediately after enemy has moved, move a further 3 inches in any direction, but not closer to any unconcealed enemy.

HERO/ HEROINE RECORD SHEET

Use heroes sparingly in battles, bear in mind most of the major figures would not be on the ground sweating with the grunts, but occasionally they can be fielded to add spice to a game, perhaps as an assassination target, part of a diplomatic convoy that is attacked etc. The points value for each figure is calculated normally, taking each as a 20 point basic hero and adding points for extra ranged fire bonus, extra skills, armour, training level, and equipment. Specific heroes can be found in each of the Beamstrike 'Era' supplements.

BEAMSTRIKE HERO RECORD			
Name:	**Sex:**		**Ranged hit Bonus:**
Race:	**Age:**		**HtH bonus:**
Skills:	**Armour:**	**Hero Point cost:**	**Loyalty:**
	Weapons:		**Equipment:**
Story:			

POINTS VALUES CHART (VERSION 1.2 CORE RULES)

The points value chart lists all of the troop types, weaponry, vehicles and equipment used in the Beamstrike rules, further descriptions of weapon systems listed can be found in appendix A. More weapons, vehicles. Robots and equipment can be slotted in, as required, for the Sci-fi 'verse' you are using, by comparing the item you wish to use with similar examples given in these rules. Spaces on the chart allow you to add your own items as needed.

Point values for troop types, equipment and vehicles listed below to allow generation of roughly balanced forces. Point values for armoured vehicles and robots and droids are found later in the book. Points are for **each** individual or weapon.

ARMOUR		WEAPONS			
Unarmoured (UA)	2	Laser pistol	2	Blast pistol	3
Fast Infantryman (FI)	5	Laser rifle	5	Blast Carbine	5
Light Armoured (LA)	8	Squad Heavy laser	8	Blast rifle	6
Power armoured (PA)	18	Auto- laser	4	Antimatter beamer	15
Assault Dreadnought (AD)	27	Sniper laser	7		
		Gyrobolt pistol	3		
		Gyrobolt rifle	4	PERSONAL EQUIPMENT	
		Rapid fire Gyrobolter	5	Targetter	3
		Heavy Gyrobolter	6	Support Targetter	8
		Support Gyrobolter	10	Digimedic	3
				Laser painter	5
		Autopistol	1		
		Machine pistol	2		
TRAINING		Assault rifle	5	VEHICLE ACCESORIES	
HERO	20	Pulse rifle (inc. riot gun)*	8	AI- turret (for up to 3 wpns)	10
ELITE	10	Automatic shotgun	3	Forward wpn mount	free
VETERAN	5	Submachine gun	3	Mecha blades	3
REGULAR	2	Machinegun	7	Mecha power claw	5
CIVILIAN	0	Sniper rifle	6	Mecha Jetpack	15
		Long Rifle	3	Gun link	5
GRENADES		Light minigun	8	Pintle mount	3
Infantryman	1	Gauss rifle	10	Command array	15
Support	2	Needle rifle	3	Sensor array	10
Specialised	3	P-Beam Rifle	15	Smoke cannisters	3
JET PACKS				ARMOURED VEHICLES	
Civilians cannot mount packs	0	Palm flamer	3	See section on vehicles and tank building	
Pack for Fast infantry/scouts	5	Flamethrower	5		
Pack for Light armour	5	Plasma gun	14	SUPPORT/ REINFORCEMENTS	
Pack for Power armour	6	Sun gun	20	Module of fire support	15
Pack for Assault Dreadnought	10			Q- travel pod	30
TROOP SKILLS		Riot gun	2	Point drop ship	20
Leadership	8	Grenade launcher*	3		
Fanatic	3	Cartridge pistol*	7		
Sniper	3	Missile launcher *	10	HAND TO HAND WPNS	
Sapper	2	LAW pistol	5	Steel Sword/ knife/ axe/ club or Vibro knife/ rifle bayonet	1
Grenadier	2	Ramjet pistol	6	Vibro or Monomolecular sword/ Axe	1.5
Medic	3			Force or power sword	2
Gunner	1	Smartgun	17	Riot Stick/ Power glove	2
Scout	3	Heavy Sniper rifle	12	Advanced force sword	3
Swordsman	3	Sonic rifle	5	Imperial Warhammer	3
FORCE SHIELDS				Imperial Warsword	4
Energy shield person/ vehicle	3/10			Power Axe	5
Projectile shield person/ vehicle	3/10	Demolition pack	5	Crimson Rebel Power Glaive	5
Null shield	15	Autocannon	20	Heavy Power axe	7
Invisibility cloak	7	Laser cannon	30	Pirate multiblades	6
Multi-shield	25	Bolt cannon	25	Light sword	10
		Robocannon turret	30	ROBOTS AND ANDROIDS	
		Rocket turret	32	See robot and Android section	

*You must also purchase a grenade pack to fire grenades.

ARMY LISTS

Army lists may be used to calculate roughly equal strength armies for competitive games. Note that where larger vehicles and artillery is introduced, the balance of the game may be upset.

Armies of around 500 points per side should give a 2-3 hour session. 1000 points per side should give a game lasting around 4-5 hours, and Large armies up to around 2000 points per side will last a whole day or longer. See the scenario ideas section for example force sizes and victory conditions.
Force organization and platoon size/ squad size etc are fairly flexible in Beamstrike; we have avoided rigid force structure and favour a more fluid approach, where players are free to choose what they like from the models they have available and the sort of game they wish to play.
Note weapons listed in army lists are those that the troops listed would normally carry. Other weapons may be equipped, depending on the scenario, with the agreement of both players; you will need to adjust point's values accordingly if this is done.

FOR SPECIFIC ARMY LISTS, PLEASE SEE THE 4 BEAMSTRIKE 'ERA' SUPPLEMENTS

Alien 'BUG' Army

Alien 'Grey' Army

Imperial Army

Crimson Rebel Army

Police Army

Mercenary Army

SECTION 3 – VEHICLES AND ARMOURED WARFARE

Although mainly replaced by Powered and Assault Dreadnought armoured troops on many worlds, there is still often a need for large armoured combat vehicles in the far flung future. Able to pack heavy weapons and with extended range, tanks and armoured personnel carriers are used during total war situations and by cultures of lower technological development levels.
Presented below are playtested, developed, rules based on Wes Camps Tank rules for Imperial Commander , further developed and expanded by Ian Garbutt. These rules include sections on Walkers, Mecha, battlesuits and many other vehicle types. A wide variety of vehicular weaponry and auxillary systems are also presented.

VEHICLE TYPES:

Beamstrike splits vehicles into two broadly different types. Softskin vehicles tend to be those in civilian use, which while able to mount weapons in some cases, tend to be found in use for transports or a 'bystanders'. A list of generic soft skin vehicles ready for play can be found in the vehicle lists at the end of this section. Armoured vehicles are those used for combat and the most numerous in the Beamstrike game. A vehicle builder chart is used to create armoured vehicles and calculate the points value for their use.

Armoured Vehicle Types:

- TANKS
- MECHA (Battlesuits)
- WALKERS
- TRANSPORTS

Some descriptional notes for each type is given below:

TANKS:

- A tank is defined as an armour- plated vehicle, mounting a variety of large weapons in a turret, and having several modes of propulsion, from tracks in low- technology societies to grav- plates in more advanced civilizations.
- A variety of tank sizes are listed in the vehicle builder chart, from the light and maneuverable scout car and light tank, to the all-round versatility of the medium tank, to the heavy and super-heavy main battle tanks.

Armoured Personnel Carrier- These vehicles are similar to light tanks, but do not have a turret mounted weapon. The extra room inside provides either protected transport for troops, OR room for command communication equipment.

APC Transport limits are as follows:

- Can transport up to 10 LI troopers.
- Can transport up to 8 AI troopers.
- Can transport up to 5 PA troopers.
- Can transport up to 3 DN troopers.

BATTLESUITS AND MECHA:
Available in various sizes and configurations, generally considered to be legged anthropomorphic (having human form) tanks, very much like huge suits of assault dreadnought armour, but where the pilot sits in a cockpit rather than 'wearing' the armour. Vulnerable to fire on limbs, and providing a very tall visible target to all on the battlefield, mecha can be as much of a liability as an asset. Special movement abilities of mecha include the ability to 'jump' using huge jetpacks. Battlesuits can mount weapon 'packs' on limbs and can 'stomp' on hapless troops who stray to close to their legs.
Although in the same category, battlesuits must have human form and be melee capable, while Mecha do not have this stipulation.

WALKERS:
Walkers are probably best described as tanks on legs. Able to operate in areas where wheeled or tracked vehicles could not enter, legged vehicles are ideal in inner city or forested areas. Not as sophisticated or expensive as grav vehicles, they never the less have their own niche. Vulnerable to hits on the legs, easy to hit, and not able to carry very heavy guns, walkers do have their limitations.

The Heavy walker is a much larger version of the light walker, some models having 4 legs rather than the standard 2. Can mount a main gun in a turret and has higher armour level.

TRANSPORTS: Large, armoured transport vehicle, used by the military to carry ammunition/ large numbers of troops or other military vehicles into action. Carry 4 times the number of troops as APCs can, or can carry 1 tank/ 2 cars or 4 bikes into action. Another variant is the Transport Walker, a large, slow, troop vehicle on legs with the same troop carrying capacity.

Restrictions on fielding armoured vehicles
Beamstrike is primarily a troop based miniature game, but vehicles may be fielded. Bear in mind that the 'balance' of a game may be upset by introducing armoured vehicles alongside foot troops. Although you may field whatever armoured vehicles you like if both players agree, generally armour will be used in proportion to the numbers of troop squads fielded.
For every 5+ man squad you have, you earn 1 armour point to spend on armoured vehicles. You can spend your points in 0.5 increments. Please note that this is the number of armoured vehicles you can field, you still have to pay the points values for them, as described in the armoured vehicle builder chart.

Fielding costs are as follows:

Super heavy/ Heavy Tanks/GMCs/ transports cost 3 ArmourP's
Medium Tanks/ Heavy walkers/Heavy Mechs cost 2 ArmourP's
Light Tanks/ light walkers/ Medium Mechs cost 1 ArmourP's
APCs/ Light mecha cost 0.5 points.

Tank Building procedure

To construct an armoured vehicle for use in the Beamstrike game, first select a hull type, bearing in mind the special bonuses/ penalties associated with each type. Next choose which locomotion type it will have, based on the choices available in the tank builder chart, and any restrictions due to the Era you are playing in.
The locomotion/ movement type will dictate what sort of terrain the vehicle will be able to operate in. Next, choose weaponry and weapon mounts and finally mount shield(s) or any vehicle accessories. Weapons and equipment mounted must obey the limit each vehicle has for the number of weapons it may mount. Once done, record the new vehicles statistics on lined paper and calculate its points value.

Armoured Vehicle Builder Chart

Type	HULL CLASS	Advanced F/S/R	Hull Cost	Movement Options	Main Gun Space	Auxiliary Spaces	Abbreviation	Troop Cap.
Armoured Personnel Carrier	2	2/2/2	20	W,FW,T,FT,H,G	0	3	APC	12
Scout Car	2	2/2/1	25	W,FW,G,H	1	1	SC	4
Light Mecha	2	2/2/2	40	A	0	5	LM	0
Light Tank	3	3/2/2	30	T,H,FG,FT,G	1	3	LT	0
Medium Mecha	3	3/3/2	55	A	2	5	MM	0
Light Walker	3	3/2/2	30	L	0	6	LW	2
Medium Tank	4	4/3/2	45	T,H,G	2	4	MT	2
Heavy Walker	4	4/3/2	55	L	3	4	HW	4
Heavy Mecha	4	4/3/3	80	HA	4	7	HM	0
Heavy tank	5	5/4/2	70	T,G	3	5	HT	4
Gun Motor Carraige	5	5/3/2	65	HT	4	3	GMC	2
Transport	5	5/4/3	45	T,G	0	7	TR	40
Transport Walker	5	5/3/3	50	HL	0	7	TW	40
Super Heavy Tank	6	6/4/3	90	HT,G	4	6	SHT	6

Hull Class: This is the hull class for penetration purposes (See vehicle armour penetration table, below). Note that mecha are expensive and have 1 class lower front hull class than equivalent sized vehicles due to vulnerability of limbs. Note that tanks and Walkers attacked from behind, have 1 less armour.
OPTIONAL RULE:
For a more realistic game, vehicle armour depends on the direction the attack originated from. Most vehicles have heavier armour on the front than they do on the sides or rear. If vehicle is attacked from the top, assume top armour is the same as the side armour.

The column labelled 'Advanced F/S/R' details the armour protection on the Front, side and rear respectively.

Hull Cost: Cost of the vehicle body including main turret (if a tank or walker), a minimal crew, but without weapons or a movement type. Note vehicle crew usually stay with the vehicle at all times and are not counted as troops for points/ moral purposes.

Movement type/cost: Lists the locomotion options available to that hull type. For the actual distances vehicles can move, see the listings in the movement chart.

Movement type	Points cost	Abbreviation	Movement type	Points cost	Abbreviation
Fast Tracked	8	FT	**Fast Grav**	25	FG
Tracked	5	T	**Legged**	10	L
Hvy Tracked	10	HT	**Hvy legged**	15	HL
Fast Wheeled	8	FW	**Hvy Grav**	30	HG
Wheeled	5	W	**Limbed**	10	A
Hover	10	H	**Hvy Limbed**	15	HA
Grav	20	G			

Main gun space: This is the maximum size of a vehicle mounted main gun which may be mounted in the turret for tanks and walkers, and shared amongst the limbs of a mecha. Note that some vehicles cannot mount main guns, they are restricted to any weapons from the infantry support and non- vehicle heavy weapons list (Usually laser cannon, Support bolters etc), and may not mount any weapon from the Main gun table below. Note there usually one main gun mount in a turret for tanks and walkers, and 1 main gun mount in each of the 2 arms of mecha/ battlesuits.

Auxiliary spaces: Gives the number of spaces for mounting weapons, shields and other equipment.

Note: More than one gun may be mounted in a turret, up to the total points room for that vehicle. For example a Heavy tank could mount 1 sized 3 gun in its turret, or a size 2 and a size 1, or 3 sized 1 guns, but NOT a sized 4 gun. Note that where multiple main guns are mounted in the same turret/ arm they must be LINKED.

Vehicle mounted Weapons Chart

This now appears in the separate Charts pack for Beamstrike 1.2

Weapon list notes: Vehicle weapons, or Main guns/ tank guns are a class of weapon usually restricted only to Armoured vehicles, some classes of turret and field artillery.

- AV = Anti-Tank round. HE = Anti-personnel round.
- The AV (CPP Anti vehicular round) has no blast template, as all the energy of the charge is penetrative.
- ** This weapon is not turret mounted, but forward firing. It may only fire straight ahead.
- Weapon mount points other than the main gun may mount any weapon from the infantry, support and heavy weapon lists
- # See the tank builder chart for details

Linked Main Guns
If you allow multiple main guns, up to a points maximum suitable for the vehicle, all those guns must be in the main turret, and linked. When you fire, all main guns must be at same target, roll for each separately for hits.
E.g.: A heavy tank has a main gun up to size 3, but you may wish to mount a size 2 gun next to a size 1 gun in the same turret. A gun linkage costing an extra 5 points MUST be used when you do this type of gun mounting.
These 'linked' gun rules were done to allow use of all the nice sci-fi models you see with twin main guns or a main gun and missile salvo next to it on the turret etc. You always get the option of NOT firing with either of the linked guns if you so wish.

VEHICLE BUILDING ACCESSORIES

In addition to vehicle mounted weapons and shields, which are explained elsewhere, armoured vehicles may also mount the following accessories, assuming sufficient auxiliary 'spaces' are available.

ITEM	Abbr	Cost	Aux points used	Notes
Electronic Counter Measures (ECM)	ECM	20	0	Confuses targeting systems and removes their to-hit bonus. For vehicle mounted weapons it imposes a penalty -2 on the to-hit. For no vehicle mounted it negates any targeter bonus.
Smoke Generator	SG	3	0	Allows vehicle to leave one SMK grenade equivalent area of smoke at any point along its movement path.One area of smoke per movement phase can be left. Area of smoke as per smoke grenade
Smoke Dispensers	SD	3	0	Vehicle can fire the equivalent of 2 smoke grenades (use grenade launcher ranges) per fire phase, in addition to other weapons. Arc of fire is as per fixed FF weapon. A stationary vehicle can smoke its own position, but penalty to hit is applied to the smoking vehicle itself as well as fire directed at it.
Robo-Turret	ROC	10	1	Detects incoming small arms and missile fire on vehicle and returns fire afterwards.
Automatic Defence System	ADS	15	1	Detects when missiles / grenade and mortar rounds are fired at vehicle. In a roll of 6-0 on a D10 it destroys the incoming round. Maximum of 2 rounds can be intercepted per turn.
Magnetic Anomaly Detector	MAD	3	0	Detects when vehicles are moving out of sight, and can indicate vehicle size, but not type.
Sensor Array	SA	10	1	Used for dedicated reconnaissance vehicles.
Command Array	CA	15	1	Allows vehicle to be used as a 'command' vehicle.
Gun Linkage	GL	5	0	Allows the linking of multiple smaller guns into a turret, rather than one large gun.
Fixed Weapon Mount	FF	Free	0	Any class of weapon may be designated as fixed. Weapon may only fire in the direction of mount facing (use template 3 for angles).
Turret Mechanism	TUR	10	0	Allows 360 degrees arc of fire for a main gun. May house any weapon class, observing the main gun room column on the tank builder chart. Turrets may be additionally added to any vehicle class allowing a 'main gun', One turret is INCLUDED in the points cost of Tanks and Walker vehicles.
Pintle Mount	PM	3	1	An infantry, support or heavy weapon mount. Allows weapon 180o arc of fire, must state facing direction. (Arc of fire the same as a troop figure)
Mech Jetpack	MJ	15	1	Allows mecha/ battlesuits 'jump' capability. See jet pack rules
Energy Shield	ES	10	1	See shield rules in core rulebook.
Projectile shield	PS	10	1	See shield rules in core rulebook.
Multi-Shield	MS	25	1	See shield rules in core rulebook.
Folding Dozer Blade	FDB	2	0	Can be deployed to dig vehicle into a hull-down position. Takes a move turn to deploy, and move turn to dig-in. Must spend another move turn retracting before vehicle can move off again.
Digging Charge	DC	2	0	AFV drops an explosive charge which blows a crater sufficiently large in ground for vehicle to go hull down in. Take a move turn to deploy charge and then another to explode it and move into hole. Any Infantry within 2 inches of vehicle when doing this take 1 Standard impact hit.
Mecha HtH capable	MHTH	6	1	Allows mecha to engage in HtH combat with other mecha or foot troops.
Mecha power claws	MPC	5	0	Mecha must already be HtH capable to fit claws
Mecha blades	MB	3	0	Mecha must already be HtH capable to fit blades

AMMUNITION

Ammunition counting and monitoring is not a requirement of Beamstrike games, so assume all are unlimited.

HITS ON VEHICLES **(See the separate Weapon charts pack for all the tables needed)**

When vehicles are subject to enemy fire, roll for hit as normal with 2d6, using vehicle specific modifiers (Table 2). Next, use the armour penetration chart (Table 3) to determine the score needed on 1d10 to penetrate the vehicles armour/ hull. The weapons damage type determines the figure needed to penetrate the vehicles armour (See table1). Vehicles each have a Hull Class, which determines its armour/ protection level. Throw the D10, if the score is LOWER than that needed, the shot does not penetrate and has no effect*. If the roll is equal to or higher, go to the vehicle effect of hit chart, rolling a d10.
*Some weapons can cause non- penetrative vehicle damage, if you wish to use this optional rule, roll 1d20 on the non- penetrating hits chart for each hit on a vehicle that did not penetrate the armour.

ARMOUR PENETRATION CHART (Throw 1d10, See Beamstrike Charts pack table 3)
VEHICLE EFFECT OF HIT CHART (Throw 1d10, cross reference against vehicle type. See charts pack, table4)

NOTE:

- A -1 modifier is applied to hull class of tanks and Walkers attacked from the rear. If the optional advanced armour rules are used, vehicle armour value depends on direction vehicle is attacked from.
- The vehicle to-Hit flow chart in the charts pack outlines the sequence of events for vehicle combat.

FORCESHIELDS

A trooper may mount one type of shield only, a vehicle may mount multiple types, but only one may be active in each turn. Shield type active is announced at the start of the players phase, use a shield template underneath the figure/ vehicle to remind you that a shield is in use. For most weapons on the infantry, support and heavy weapon list, fitting a shield deducts 3 from any applicable

weapons armour penetration roll on the armour penetration chart for vehicles, or -3 on the damage table for figures. The guns on the tank gun list, along with the missile launcher firing anti tank missiles, and AV grenade are much more powerful and are designed to defeat such shielding, so only have a -1 penalty. Note that no type of shield protects against flamers, sun guns and sonic weapons.

SHIELD (Abbreviation used)	Protects against following weapons	Infantry weapons	TANK GUNS and AT missile/ AV grenade	Notes
Energy Shield (ES)	Lasers, blast weapons, beam guns	-3	-1	Vehicle version costs 10 points Troop version costs 3 points
Projectile shield (PS)	Bolters, bullet weapons, ramjet shots,40-160mm tank gun, rail gun, Vulcan, missile, grenade.	-3	-1	Vehicle version costs 10 points. Troop version costs 3 points.
Multi shield (MS)	As *either* ES *or* PS above	-2	-1	Vehicles only, costs 25 points
Null Shield (Figure only) (NS)	All	Cannot be harmed	Cannot be harmed	User may not fire while this shield is active. May laser paint. Cost is 15 points.
Stealth Cloak (figure only) (SC)	None	No protection	No protection	Light bending, chameleon shield, makes wearer invisible in most lighting conditions. Any fire toward cloaked figure -3 penalty. Cost is 7 points.

Hits on forceshields

At the end of each fire phase, if a shield has received hits that didn't penetrate the armour(including null shields and invisibility cloaks), there is still a chance the shield has overloaded and failed. Roll a 1d6, the shield goes down on a roll of 6. If the shield has suffered penetrating hits, it goes down on a roll of 3-6. Downed shields remain so for the rest of the game. In vehicles mounting more than one type of shield, a downed shield does not affect the operation of another shield fitted, which may then be turned on.

Shield mounting on vehicles

Any vehicle may mount one shield with no mount point used. Additional shields cost 1 mount point. The benefit of fitting more than one shield is that if one is knocked out or overloaded, another can be switched on, or if the vehicle is attacked by a different weapon type, a different suitable shields can be raised which will protect the vehicle. Multi shields offer the benefits of both ES and PS shields in one compact package, but only either ES or PS protection can be active at any time, cost is more and protection against small arms is slightly inferior though.

Cover and Vehicles

Vehicles that are in soft cover cannot claim to be concealed at all. Vehicles in Hard/ reinforced cover can be concealed and cannot be fired upon unless they EXPOSE themselves by firing, or are picked up by bio sensors (vehicles can become even more concealed by switching off the engines etc, but then they can't move)

If any tank finds cover which conceals all but its turreted weapon or top half, it is said to be 'hull down' or 'in defilade' and in such cases, any fire directed towards the vehicle **does not** get the usual 'vehicles' bonus to hit.

The cover may be the simple tactic of positioning the tank just behind the crest of a hill, so that to troops advancing, they can only see the turret or main gun, or 4 or more infantry troops ' digging in' the vehicle for 2 movement phases, in which case a 'deployed' marker is place next to the vehicle. As soon as the vehicle moves, however, it is not 'dug in' any more. See vehicle accessories for other equipment available to 'dig in' vehicles.

Suitable VEHICLE models

Tabletop games (TTG) sold by15mm.co.uk produce a large range of miniature figures and some vehicles, 'Old Crow' and 'Ground Zero Games (GZG)' produce resin 15mm tank kits very reasonably priced. Alternatively 1:72 scale plastic tank kits can be suitably altered and modified for the role. Star Wars™ AT-AT™ walkers from the Micro-machines Action-fleet range are suitably sized to represent Heavy transport walkers. Mecha and battlesuit models are harder to find for 15mm play, but the 'Heavy Gear' range or MechWarrior range have some nice models which will 'scale' fit.

Notes on Technology/ Battlefield assumptions at work (Imperial Era)

Although large, vulnerable to taking more fire and slower, armoured vehicles have a limited but important place on the future battlefield.

Main guns firing solid projectiles can fire Anti- vehicular(AV) rounds, which have a monomolecular tipped, depleted deuterium armour piercing warheads specifically for cutting through future laminated composite reactive armour plate. High Explosive (HE) anti personnel rounds are targeted at ground troops and soft vehicles, having a large blast area, and more widely distributed explosive effect.

When armoured vehicles get in close to troops with plasma, bolt and sun weapons, they don't last very long! unless shielded, something worth bearing in mind if you are spending lots of points on tanks etc……Plasma and sun guns, though short ranged, will cut into all but the most heavily armoured vehicles, and have the bonus that they are not affected by shielding.

Bolt gun armed troops, when faced with tanks and APCs, will switch to armour piercing or 'phase' rounds, to give a real chance of defeating future armour.

Example vehicles for Beamstrike games

The following list of vehicles provide some 'ready to play' vehicles for Beamstrike games, with the point's values pre-filled and listing the armaments and equipment included in the price. Note vehicles are for the Imperial Era of the Beamstrike timeline.

Crimson Rebel Vehicles

Vehicle	Point cost	Hull Class	Type	Movement type	Main Gun	Auxiliary gun points	Troops capacity	Model available	Shield
Trike	18	1	-	Trike	-	2x FF linked autogyrobolters	1	TTM-408/ 408a	-
Command Trike	35	2	-	Trike	-	Heavier armour, laser painter	1	TTM-410	ES
Skimmer scout	15	1	-	Hover	-	-	2	TTM-415	-
Hvy Wpn Skimmer	70	2	-	Hover	-	AI-turret with laser cannon	2	TTM-416	ES
Rebel multi-tank-MBS	179	5	HT	Grav	100mm	MG x2 in turret Missile launcherx2 forward firing	0	OC: Sabre hvy tank	PS
Rebel multi-tank- ISV	170	5	HT	Grav	2xmissile salvo	2x support bolter AI-turret	0	OC: Sabre hvy tank	PS
Rebel multi-tank-APC	150	5	HEV	Grav	Command array	1 Bolt cannon in AI-turret	6	OC: Sabre hvy tank	PS
'Egor' light Walker	98	3	LW	Legged	-	Bolt cannon in AI-turret, 2xFf heavy laser	0	-	PS
Gladius Medium tank	100	4	MT	Tracked	Rail gun	2x FF flamethrower	0	OC: Gladius med tank	PS
'Zandrine' Medium Mech	129	3	MM	legged	**Left arm**: AA Vulcan, Missile launcher. **Right arm**: Sun cannon, Hvy laser		0	Use Mechwarrior models	ES
Allor drop ship	220	5	-	Aircraft	-	2x AI turret with laser cannon in	24	OC: crow lander	ES

Police / Law Enforcement Vehicles

Vehicle	Point cost	Hull Class	Type	Movement type	Main Gun	Auxiliary gun points	Troops capacity	Model available	Shield
Police Support bike	17	1	-	Trike	-	Mounts forward firing 4 barrel GL	0	TTM-102	-
Police Jetcopter	62	2	-	Aircraft	-	4x forward firing MG	4	TTM-V007	PS
Police Gun bike	15	1	-	Trike	-	2xFF linked Assault rifles	0	TTM-102	-
Police APC	25	2	APC	Wheeled	-	none	10	-	-

Imperial Vehicles

Vehicle	Point cost	Hull Class	Type	Movement type	Main Gun	Auxiliary gun points	Troops capacity	Model available	Shield
Drop Lander	184	4	-	Aircraft/ anti grav	-	2x AI-turrets with laser cannon.	12	TTM-LB-V011	ES
Troop transport	25	2	APC	Wheeled or tracked	-	2	8	OC: Glaive APC or TTM Glaive	-
Hover transport	30	2	APC	Hover	-	2	8	OC: Glaive APC or TTM Glaive	-
Grav transport	40	2	APC	Grav	-	2	8	OC: Glaive APC or TTM Glaive	-
Imp. Scout bike	25	1	-	Trike	-	Mounts forward firing 2x missile launcher	1	TTM-317	-
Imp. Jetspeeder	17	1	-	Fast grav	-	1 hvy laser forward firing	1	TTM-207/207a	-
Razor jetcopter	30	2	-	Aircraft	-	2	6	TTM-V007	-
Light scout car	18	2	-	Hover	-	1	4	TTM-V010	-

Vehicle	Point cost	Hull Class	Type	Movement type	Main Gun	Auxiliary gun points	Troops capacity	Model available	Shield
Scout Copter	26	2	-	Aircraft	-	2	1	TTM-V105	-
Imperial Troop walker	171	5	TRAW	Hvy. legged	-	2xFF laser cannon, 2x FF heavy laser, command array	40	Micromachines AT-AT	ES
Sword Light tank	93	3	LT	Fst.GRAV	40mm	1 FF Hvy laser	0	GZG:Light grav tank V15-09A	ES
Stryker Medium tank	106	4	MT	Tracked	75mm	2xFF heavy laser	0	GZG: Puma light tank V15-02A	ES
Sandman Heavy tank	163	5	HT	GRAV	100mm	1 Hvy laser AI-turret 2xFF Flamethrowers	0	GZG:V15-08A Grav MBS	ES

CIVILIAN VEHICLES									
Vehicle	Point cost	Hull Class	Type	Movement type	Main Gun	Auxiliary gun points	Troops capacity	Model available	Shield
Transport Jetcopter	50	1	-	Aircraft	-	2	12	OC: Crow lander	-
Hover scout car	20	1	-	Hover	-	1	5	TTM-V010	-
Motorbike	5	0	-	Trike	-	1	0	TTM-102	-
Air raft/ Flit car	15	1	-	Hover	-	none	4	TTM-V101	-
Hover Truck	20	1	-	Hover	-	none	10	TTM-V103	-

POINT COST: Beamstrike points cost for vehicle, including crew, any weapons listed, and any equipment listed. Note if no weapons listed for main gun or auxiliary weapon, but just a number of possible fitments, the weapons points cost is extra as there is the option of whatever armament fitment best suits the vehicle role.
HULL CLASS: See armour penetration chart.
TYPE: Tank type on the tank builder charts, note this does not apply to lighter vehicles, or aircraft.
MOVEMENT TYPE: Vehicles movement class, see movement rules below.
MAIN GUN: Lists the main gun fitted, as per tank builder chart.
AUX GUNS: Lists the number of auxiliary gun points. For each gun point, a single fixed gun (must state forward firing, side or rear) ,or a Roboturret, which costs an extra 10 points (with up to 3 guns in)may be fitted. NOTE you cannot fit a main gun (from the main gun chart) in an auxiliary location. (Note: FF= forward firing)
TROOP CAPACITY: Number of unarmoured/ lightly armoured troops vehicle can carry, not including the actual driver/ cyclist/ pilots. See rule section below.
MODEL AVAILABLE: Lists available 15mm lead or resin model available and the manufacturers' code number if known. Abbreviations are OC= Old Crow model, GZG= Ground Zero Games model, TTM= Tabletop Games model (from 15mm.co.uk)

Old Crow Models: (The 15mm range) **http://www**.oldcrowmodels.co.uk/15mm.htm
Ground Zero Games: (The SG 15 vehicles) **http://www.gtns.co.uk/store1/**
15mm.co.uk (The Laserburn range) http://www.15mm.co.uk
SHIELD: Type of shield(s) fitted as standard, although any vehicle may mount shields for extra points.

Troop Passenger Capacities

Troop capacities listed are for Fast Infantry (FI) type troops, for other troop types multiply the troop capacity depending on the troop type. Round any fractions down. Example, an APC has a troop capacity of 12. It may hold 12x FI troops, 9x LA troops, 6x PA troops or 4x AD troops.

Civilian/ fast Infantry x 1	Power Armoured x 0.5
Light Armoured x 0.8	Assault Dreadnought x 0.3

Special Rules for Bikes/ Trikes/Quads and Skimmers

Bikes/ Trikes/ Quads and skimmers are collectively known as 'Bikes' in these rules.
If a moving bike has one of its occupants hit, throw randomly to see who is hit, a fatal hit on the driver/ cyclist means roll a 1d6. A roll of 1-2 means the vehicle is knocked out (crashes), other occupants escape on the roll of 4-6 on a 1d6, else killed (roll for each).
A bike with no driver then stops for 1 move phase. Any other passenger may then take the roll of the driver, or another UA/ LA troop may enter the vehicle and drive it (including enemy troops!)
The driver or gunner may dismount and mount back as wished (takes 1 move phase to mount/ dismount), obviously the bike cannot move whilst there is no driver!

WEAPONS ON BIKES
Motorbikes, and quads may mount up to 2 infantry weapons as forward firing fixed

mounts. Trikes and Skimmers may mount up to 2 light support or infantry weapons (of the same type) as forward firing fixed mounts. Duplicate forward firing weapons are linked, fire as one, but roll twice for effect of hit. A skimmer may mount one AI turret instead of passengers.

Special rules for Battlesuits or Mecha

Battlesuits and similar mecha have several disadvantages, a high points cost, a slightly lower armour level and they are easier hit than equivalent armoured vehicles. This is weighed up against some unique abilities:

JUMP
A mecha/ battlesuit with a jump pack may jump in exactly the same way as troops may jump. The jump distance is dependant on the weight of the Mecha:
Light Mecha/ Battlesuit: 20 inches
Heavy Mecha/Battlesuit: 8 inches
Medium Mecha/ Battlesuit: 14 inches
The Jump accident rules still apply, the accident score being 9. If an accident happens, roll as if vehicle suffered penetrating hit (i.e. roll 1d10 on vehicle effect of hit table)

STOMP
During a mecha/ battlesuit movement phase, it may elect to perform 'offensive' movement which is half distance, but any troops within 1 ½ inches of the end position of the Mecha after its move must roll 'troop rolls' to avoid being stomped on/ kicked by the Mecha. Failed saving throws mean troop takes a 'standard' impact hit. Note that this attack happens in the 'move' phase, and enemy troops do not get a chance to retaliate until the next fire phase. Also note that troops in hard / reinforced cover or those in vehicles are not affected; only those in the open, in craters or soft cover may be stomped.

OVERTURN
A novel ability of Mecha and Battlesuits is to overturn enemy wheeled, legged or tracked vehicles, rendering them immobile!- overturning cannot be done to grav/ hover vehicles however. During a Mecha's movement phase, if it ends its movement within 1 ½ inches of an enemy vehicle, it may attempt an overturn manoeuvre at the end of that move phase. The target vehicle must have a hull class less than the Mecha's hull class. The Mecha makes a troop roll and if successful the target vehicle is rendered immobile (upside down). If the troop roll fails, the target vehicle is unaffected. Note mecha cannot overturn other Mecha, or hover/ grav vehicles.

MECHA MELEE COMBAT
Any Mecha or battlesuit can be classed as Melee capable. This means the vehicle is humanoid shaped and has 'hands' or 'fists' of some kind, allowing hand to hand combat with other Mecha or foot troops. Melee capability costs 6 points and uses one weapon/ equipment mount point.
Mecha are usually considered 'Regular' troop type.
A mecha or Battlesuit losing the HtH roll is not automatically destroyed, but instead takes an automatically penetrating vehicle hit, the result of which is determined normally.

Mecha hand to hand combat is handled in exactly the same way as other melee combat but with the following additional modifiers:

Small mecha/ suit (Hull 2)	+12	Medium mecha/ suit (Hull 3)	+15	Heavy mecha/ suit (Hull 4)	+19
Mecha 'Blades' fitted	+2	Mecha power claw fitted:	+5		

Mecha may enhance their hand to hand combat capability with the following fittings (do not take up any additional mount points):
BLADES: Mecha armoured fist is toughened and has power blades on forearms to rip through metal and flesh. Costs 3 points.
POWER CLAW: Huge powered grappling claw, works like a power glove but much bigger. Costs 5 points.

Special rules for cars/Vans/ APCs and Tanks

RAM
Vehicles may choose to 'ram' during their movement phase, the outcome depends on the relative strengths/ weights of the ramming forces as indicated below: To successfully ram, vehicle must end its move at the object it wishes to ram, even if it could have moved further. If vehicles ram troops, any within 1inch of the vehicles final position must make troop rolls or be hit as below. Note that troops may not 'ram' each other!
For all types of vehicles, the vehicles 'hull size' is the ramming force, CIV/FI/LA troops count as hull class '0', PA/AD troops count as hull size 1.

Compare the difference in ramming force:

- **No difference:** Both objects: Both objects roll 1d6, 1-3 no effect, 4-5 stunned, 6 take 1 hit.
- **1 difference:** Larger object 'Glancing hit' on roll of 4 or 6 on 1d6, smaller object automatic near miss and takes 1 hit on a roll of 5 or 6 on a 1d6.
- **2 difference:** Larger object 'Glancing hit' on the roll of a 6 on 1d6, smaller object roll 1d6.1-2 OK, 3-4 Stunned, 5-6, takes 1 hit.
- **3 or more difference:** Larger object takes no damage, smaller object takes 1 hit and is 'stunned'

NOTE: A 'hit' on a trooper is at 'high' damage, a hit on a vehicle automatically penetrates armour and a roll is made on the vehicle effect of hit chart, using 1d10. All other hit effects are explained in the troop/ vehicle hit effects, except 'Glancing hit' on a vehicle. Vehicle 'Glancing hits' operate the same as troop glancing hits

Note that grav vehicles may ram anything, Hover may ram anything except Grav, and ground (wheeled and tracked) vehicles may only ram other ground vehicles.

Command Vehicles

Any vehicle above hull size 1 can be designated 'command' vehicles, by purchasing a command array. This package of communications and avionic devices gives the following bonuses:

- Off table fire support requests succeed on a roll of 3-6 on a d6 for ALL of that army, regardless of who actually designates.
- Enemy troop/ vehicle concealment ranges are HALVED.
- All friendly vehicles get NO penalties if scenario is a night fight/ in adverse weather etc.
- Any vehicles on table can give indirect fire support, if they have grenade/ missile launchers or missile salvos.

Note that an APC/ Skimmer fitted with a command array cannot carry troops (only the operating crew), and the array uses one auxiliary weapon mount point. Costs 15 points.

Reconnaissance vehicles

A sensor array can be purchased for a reconnaissance vehicle (any vehicle bigger than hull size 1), and allows the following bonuses to that **vehicle ONLY:**

- Used for dedicated reconnaissance vehicles. Lets the scout vehicle designate targets for off table fire support, with a successful request needing 3+ on a D6.
- Enemy troop/vehicle concealment ranges are HALVED.
- Can give indirect fire support if vehicle has grenade or missile launcher/ salvo.

Note that an APC/ skimmer fitted with a sensor array can only carry half (round down) the number of troops compared to the standard vehicle, the sensor array uses one weapon mount point and costs 10 points.

Vehicle Crews

Trikes/ bikes/ quads and skimmers use troops for crew, which must be paid for separately and may dismount and fight normally (they often do this, use the crew monitor markers to keep track of who is on which bike)

For larger vehicles, the crew are included in the points cost for the vehicle and these soldiers are not expected to take part in the action. They can be treated as regular, unarmoured infantry with a pistol in exceptional circumstances if the scenario allows vehicle crews to leave their vehicles.

Many larger vehicles use droid brains or computers for much of the vehicles operation.

OPTIONAL CREW TRAINING LEVEL RULE

Vehicle crews are assumed to have a skill level of 'regular', for firing purposes (no modifier), and roll a '4' for troop rolls if needed. If both players agree, crews can be any troop rating, but this modifies the points cost of the vehicle as below:

Crew Rating	Vehicle Points cost modifier	Vehicle hit bonus	Vehicle 'troop' roll
Regular (Standard rules)	none	none	4
Veteran	+10	+1	4
Elite	+20	+2	3
Hero	+30	+3	2
Civilian	-5	-2	6

SECTION 4 – 15MM MINIATURE BATTLES

PRINTING THIS PDF BOOK

This free set of rules has been released as a PDF document for viewing on your personal computer. You will probably wish to print this book and bind or place the loose pages in a protective document folder (these can be purchased quite cheaply). Bear in mind when printing that many home ink jet printers will use a considerable amount of ink, considering the page count and number of pictures included.

SETTING UP FOR PLAY

- Mutually agree the size of the play area, and set out terrain features either randomly, take turns placing items or get a third person to set up the battlefield. A typical table for a 15mm game of Beamstrike will measure anything from 3 foot square to 12 foot by 5 foot.

- For each terrain item, decide what type of cover it provides, sketch simple internal maps for buildings if you are allowing buildings to be entered, and agree what each type of terrain is classed as for cover and movement purposes.

- It is worth agreeing this now, as in the heat of battle, that patch of rubble strewn ruins may arguably be soft or hard cover, and difficult or impassable ground depending on your perspective!

- Decide who is the attacker and who is the defender, or if you can't decide roll 1d10 each, highest chooses. Note attacker is Player 'A' with regards to the rules, and goes first.

- Decide if there is to be a time factor for the game. This can be useful if one of you has to finish the game in say, a couple of hours. At this time point, the winner is the person who inflicted the highest point's value in killed units/ destroyed vehicles to the opponent's army.

- Decide if there will be any larger armoured vehicles allowed.

- For formal battles at war-game clubs, you may wish to make sure all your models are painted/ based and you have sufficient time/ scenery/ dice/ templates/ carry cases/ food and drink to ensure an enjoyable gaming session and experience.

- Optionally, decide if there are any adverse battle conditions (can add extra spice to a game), some suggestions are presented below:

ADVERSE BATTLE CONDITIONS CHART

1d10	Condition	Effect
1-5	None	None
6	Night	Sensor ranges halved (round down), -1 firing penalty to all shots unless targeter used. FI and LA infantry figures move at half rate.
7	Bad weather	Torrential rain/ snow storm/ sand storm/ hurricane as suitable for world type. All movement halved (vehicles included) -2 firing penalty to ALL shots.
8	High Gravity	World has high gravity, un-powered troops (FI and LA) have all movements halved.
9	Meteor shower or space/air battle in progress overhead and debris raining down	At the very end of each turn, roll 1d6. On a 3-6 impact the equivalent of an advanced HE grenade (blast template C) on a random point of the table. (You can do this by measuring each table edge and rolling d100/1000 on each table axis. E.g. table is 120 inches by 60 inches. Roll 1d100+1d20 for one axis and 3d20) on the other axis. Axis zero position is to Player As left corner)
0	Energy storms	Heavy rain, hail, lightning, energy disturbances. -1 firing penalty to all combatants, Each start turn throw 1d6. 1-3: no additional effect, 4-5: targeters have NO bonus, 6: All electricals down for turn, robots and androids will cease to function , vehicles may Not move, AI-turrets won't work etc. Throw per turn start.

OBSTACLES AND SCENERY

Players may wish to have rivers, barbed wire, tank traps, minefields, trenches or other obstacles on their Beamstrike battlefields. The following rules allow their use.

RIVERS:

May be **shallow**, in which case movement across them is halved for foot soldiers and wheeled/ tracked vehicles. Jetpack jumps, legged, hover, grav or flying vehicles are unaffected.

Deep rivers prevent crossing by foot troops, legged, wheeled and tracked vehicles completely; they must find or build a bridge. Jetpack jumps (provided jump distance is long enough to cross river span), hover, grav or flying vehicles unaffected.

Optionally you may allow LA/PA/ AD troops (with integrated breathing apparatus) to cross deep rivers at half move rate. Whilst underwater they may not fire and are at a penalty of -3 to hit.

BARBED WIRE: (4 inch long section)

Barbed or razor wire in Beamstrike uses monomolecular ribbons of wire which are razor sharp, very strong and seriously impede lightly armoured troops. UA, FI and LA troops may not cross intact sections of wire, PA and AD troops throw 1d6 if they wish to cross. 1-3 Cross OK, 4-5 stuck, end movement phase level with the wire, may move off next move phase.6 figure entangled and killed.

Wire may be jet packed over without problem. Legged, tracked, grav, and hover vehicles are unimpeded by wire. Wheeled vehicles may cross, but throw 1d6. Roll of 1, vehicle passes through and destroys a 2 inch section of wire, 2-5 vehicle passes Ok, 6 means vehicle stuck for rest of game. Trikes and wheeled bikes throw as per PA/AD troops. Wheeled and tracked vehicles passing through wire destroy a 2 inch wide section.

Destroying wire: A sapper (see troop characteristics) may make a 2 inch wide opening in wire if he spends his whole move phase doing so (i.e. it is an 'action'). Wire may be destroyed in 2 inch sections by a deliberate hit by any of the following weapons: Any tank gun, Plasma gun, sun gun, HE or AP grenade/ missile hit. (Hit required only, automatic destruction of a section)

TANK TRAPS (4 inch long sections)

Tank traps are devices employed to restrict the movement of ground vehicles whilst allowing troops to move relatively freely. UA/ FI and LA troops treat tank trapped areas as open ground, PA and AD and wheeled bikes/ trikes/ legged vehicles treat as difficult ground. Larger wheeled/ tracked/ hover vehicles cannot pass unless traps destroyed. Grav vehicles can move over the top of traps freely.

Destroying traps: Of robust construction, may be destroyed by any of: Tank gun, Plasma gun, sun gun, HE or AP grenade/ missile hit, laser or bolt cannon. A KILL result against equivalent of Assault Dreadnought armour is needed to destroy a 2 inch section. Some very large vehicles may require a wider section than this to pass through unhindered.

MINEFIELD: (4 inches by 8 inches)

Deployed in sections measuring 8 inches by 4 inches. Foot troops, wheeled, tracked AND hover vehicles affected (modern minefields use munitions which detect vehicles within 2 metres of the ground). Jetpack jumps (as long as you clear the whole minefield), anti grav vehicles unaffected.

For each turn troops or vehicles move over field, throw 1d6 for each to see if mine triggered:

TROOP/ VEHICLE TYPE	MINE TRIGGERED IF YOU ROLL a…
CIV, FI or LA	6
PA or AD	5 or 6
Trike, bike, hover, legged vehicle	4-6
Other wheeled or tracked vehicle	3-6

If a mine is set off, place a blast template 1 under the triggering object. All troops within blast range are hit as per Armour piercing 'High' damage type, any vehicles take a 'power' damage type hit.

Clearing minefields: A sapper skilled figure may 'clear' an area 2 inches by 1 inch long each move phase. Alternatively, minefields may be 'bombed out' by 2 hits per 4 inch squared section of minefield by off table fire support or Missile launcher/ salvo hit.

Using minefields: May be purchased by defenders as part of initial setup, may be placed as part of initial scenery setup. May be known (marked and known as a minefield by both sides), or 'secret', location noted by the owner, and the other player only knows of its existence when dicing is made for troops traveling over it, at the end of the move phase they moved onto the minefield.

TRENCH: (4 inch long, 1 inch wide)

Trenches may be cut/ dug pre combat and points paid for doing this. Some trenches may already be available and agreed as part of initial scenery layout. In any case, trenches count as 'hard' cover for troops in them. Troops may move at 'difficult ground' rate whilst in them. You may jetpack out of a trench OK. Jetpacking into a trench counts as a jump risk, so roll on the jump risk chart when this is done.

Wheeled vehicles count trenches as impassable, other vehicles may pass over trenches OK.

CRATERS: (2 inch diameter circle)
When any of the following hit/ go off: Demolition charge, missile launcher/ salvo hit, off table fire support or 75mm or greater CPP tank gun. Place a crater marker in this position (2 inch diameter circle). A crater prevents a wheeled vehicle passing over it, and counts as difficult ground for foot troops and tracked vehicles. It provides 'hard' cover for any foot troops moving into it.

ROADS:
Give bonus to the movement of ground vehicles, as long as road is intact and rubble/ debris free. Offers absolutely no cover (Even a sniper cannot claim cover bonus if deployed on a road (see sniper rules above))

OPEN GROUND:
This is reasonably flat short grasslands, scrublands, desert etc with a few bushes, small stones etc. Allows reasonably unrestricted movement, cover, when available, will be isolated areas of foliage and rocks etc

DIFFICULT GROUND:
Rubble strewn landscape, partially destroyed buildings, steeply hilly, rocky ground, and light woods present real movement problems for troops and vehicles.

IMPASSABLE GROUND:
Intact buildings will not usually allow vehicle access, deep rivers will stop access to foot troops, wheeled and tracked vehicles, lava flows may prevent access to all ground moving forces, ravines or craters can prevent movement etc…..

BUILDINGS AND BUNKERS:

In some games these may need purchasing, in others may be set up as part of the initial scenery placement. Some buildings may form part of a player's morale strength, see the morale rules. Normal buildings count as Hard cover for troops within. Bunkers are specialised fortifications providing maximum protection for occupants (reinforced cover), but allowing firing points along most walls.

You may decide before a game to allow access into buildings, in which case simple floor plans may be needed, or alternatively access may only be on the roof, in which case it takes one movement phase to go from the roof to within 1 inch of any door on the ground floor. Note the rules on building demolition. Ideally building models will have removable roofs, allowing accurate placement of occupants.

FIRING FROM BUILDINGS
When positioning troops at firing positions within buildings, 2 troops may fire from each window (1/2 inch width), 3 troops may fire from a long (1 inch) firing slit in a bunker. 2 troops may fire from each doorway. Troops firing from a building, still get a full cover bonus.

BOOBY TRAPS:
You may allow the placing of booby traps as part of a tabletop set-up. Each booby trap costs 3 or 5 points (depending on the size of the charge), and is marked on the tabletop with a 'hidden' marker or similar. Any element coming within 1.5 inches of the marker must roll 1d6 to see if the trap has been detonated:

Troop/ Vehicle type	Trap triggered if you roll a……..
Any unskilled trooper	5-6
Any scout/ sapper skilled trooper	6
Any vehicle	4-6

Triggered small booby traps detonate as an AP grenade (blast template1), large traps detonate as a FHE grenade (template 3)- any elements in the blast area are affected (but roll for hit using the grenade rules) and the triggering element is AUTOMATICALLY hit.
Sapper skilled troops may disarm each booby trap by moving to a point 1.5 inches away from the trap and rolling a 1d6: 1= Trap detonates, Sapper is hit. 2= Trap remains active, 3-6= Trap removed. Alternatively each trap may be targeted by any explosive weapon. No roll to hit is needed, instead, roll 1d6. 1-4= trap remains, 5 or 6= trap destroyed.

POINTS COSTS FOR COMMON FORTIFICATIONS					
Pre- blown crater	2	Per 4 inch wire	5	Small bunker 4 inch by 4 inch	40
Small Booby Trap	3	Per 4 inch Tank trap	10	Unfortified house/ barn	5
Large Booby Trap	5	Per 4 inch trench	4	Large building	10
		Per 4x8 inch Minefield	30	Large bunker 12x8 inch	100

Example Game Scenarios for Beamstrike

The table below can help give a starting place for a simple game, suggesting points to spend per side, where the forces begin on the table, and under what conditions the winner is decided. The point's values given should give games lasting about 3-4 hours, including setup time and laying out terrain etc.

You may alter the setup positions etc as mutually agreed before the game. In games where a pre- nominated figure is to be assassinated or a certain object demolished, this can be a 'secret' nomination by the attacker of one of the enemies main leaders/ heroes/ vehicles/bridges (in which case write it down on a piece of paper and put the paper in an envelope or similar.

This should make for a more interesting game as the defender won't know what he is defending and the attacker may bluff/ double bluff with his forces etc.

Victory conditions can be altered to suit the sizes of the forces in play or the terrain used.

1d20	Name	Points each Attacker/ Defender	Attacker setup	Defender Setup	Victory conditions
1-6	**Patrol**	500/ 500	Within 12ins of table edge	Within 12 ins of table edge	Standard
7-8	**Ambush**	500/700	At either side of the road/ path and in cover	Down centre of board, no farther than half way towards the attacker's base edge, 8 ins wide, usually on a road or path. Defender sets up first.	Defenders win if they manage to get 25% of the point value of forces up the road and off the table.
9-10	**Checkpoint breakthrough**	600/ 1000	Within 12 ins table edge. Defender sets up first. Must exit table from within 3 inches of the road. May jump wall/ wire with jet packs if capable.	Up to half the table, must be in the form of a wall or barbed wire line cutting table in 2, with checkpoint in the middle	Attackers win if they get 20% of the points value of their forces through the checkpoint defenses and up the road and off the table.
11-13	**Assault**	1000/1000	Within 12 ins of table edge	Has up to half of the table setup with defenses.	Standard
14	**Assassination**	500/1000	Within 8 ins table edge	Has whole ¾ of the rest of table	Attacker wins if a pre- nominated enemy figure (one of their main leaders) is killed. Defender must field at least 3 leaders.
15	**Demolition**	500/1000	Within 8 ins table edge	Has whole ¾ of rest of table	Attacker wins if a pre-nominated building/ bridge/ vehicle is destroyed. Sappers with demolition packs may be needed. There must be at least 3 buildings on the table. The defender lays out the buildings, but none must be within 10 inches of the defender's edge.
16	**Last stand**	1000/500	On any table edge surrounding defender, only up to 2 ins onto table.	Within 8 ins of the middle of the table, usually in some sort of building or cover	The defenders win if they manage to survive for 3 turns, when massive reinforcements turn up
17	**Convoy**	500/1000	At either side of the road/ path and in cover.	Down centre of board, 8 ins wide, usually on a road or path. Must spend at least 100 points on vehicles. Defender sets up road, which must enter and exit the table from both base edges. Defender sets up first, no farther than 15 inches towards the attacker's edge.	Defenders win if they manage to get 25% of the points value of vehicles off the attacker's table edge. Vehicles must exit table from within 3 inches of the road.
18	**Sniper Alley**	200/600	2 or 3 sniper troops well deployed/ dug in in buildings or on hill tops.	Within 12 ins of table edge.	Snipers win if they can survive for 3 turns
19	**City War**	500/500	Within 12 ins of table edge, lots of buildings and restricted ranges. SMG/ template weapons win the day	Within 12 ins of table edge	Standard
20	**Total War**	1000-2000	Within 20 ins of table edge	Within 20 ins of table edge	Standard

Other scenario ideas:

- **Civilian riot.** Police forces struggle to contain civilian unrest/ riot in mega-city streets. Riot squads armed with riot sticks and stun gas, loads of civilians, egged on by lightly armed ringleaders threaten to overrun the police on sheer numbers alone. Similar riots in Prisons, on ships, or any other public area can be staged.

- **Dropzone.** Dropships are dropping in troops/ equipment from low orbit. Well positioned enemy forces including anti aircraft emplacements are shooting the hell out of the incoming troops. Dropships are not counted in the points value as they clear off after dropping troops and are not allowed to fire (unless points paid, in which case they hang around for the action). Improvised rules for incoming drop ships clearing ground defenses could be introduced to give some variability in the numbers of forces the attacker manages to get intact to the war zone.

- **Civilian protection/ evacuation operation.** The escorting of a civilian group/ VIP through hostile territory (perhaps terrorists/ insurgents are near?) This type of scenario can focus the commander on protecting forces, rather than planning for all –out carnage, regardless of cost.

- **Bootleg/ arms run** of a few armed trucks through a blockade or checkpoint

- **Armoured battle.** Tank warfare requires a large playing area, but can be visually spectacular if you have the necessary space. Large points value forces may lead to long games, so a strict time limit or specified victory conditions will need to be adhered to. The more exotic vehicle types can be exciting to field, battles with battlesuits and Mecha, alongside regular infantry are particularly interesting.

- **Rebel Civil War.** Battles within rival Rebel factions, with the possibility of hired guns, demobbed Imperial troops in the mix. With all those fanatic troops on the table it could be a massacre!

- **Shipboard combat.** Using small points value forces (perhaps 300 per side), and 15mm deck plans, you could hold ship boarding actions, restrictions on weapon classes, as hull puncture is bad news for both sides, close combat the order of the day. This scenario can provide a quick melee battle, using the hand to hand rules to full effect.

Victory conditions

Some of the scenario suggestions above have unique victory conditions based on the story being followed. In patrol/ war games where both sides are just intent on carnage standard victory conditions are used with the following rules :

- Decide if there is to be a time factor for the game (say game ends in 5 turns) At this time point, the winner is the person who inflicted the highest points value in killed units/ destroyed vehicles to the opponents army.

If there is no time restraint or the forces nearly annihilate each other before this, the following victory conditions apply:

- If one force is broken due to morale loss and is forced to retreat for 3 or more consecutive move phases, it has lost.
- If one force looses all of its units, it has obviously lost.

SECTION 5- BACKGROUND

BEAMSTRIKE TIMELINE

- 13.7 billion years BC – the Big Bang…
- 1969AD – On 20th July Armstrong sets foot on the moon. With "one small step…" humanity is no longer confined to Earth.
- 2003AD – WTO conference in Cancun, Mexico, Earth. The year two thousand and three, by old Earth reckoning. A conference of the World Trade Organisation ends in turmoil. The conference intends to implement fair trade policies for the world's poorest countries, but the USA doesn't want to play. Instead, laws are passed that make it easier to protect the interests of the rich and to exploit the poor.
- 2010AD – **The Segregation**. The working classes are confined to ghettos throughout much of Europe.
- 2090AD – By now, regime-change has been forced by the USA on the whole of Asia and Africa over refusals to allow trade involving genetically modified seeds and crops.
- 2095AD – The USA does the same to Europe, for the same reason.
- 2459AD – After centuries of oppression, the segregated lower classes rise up. They are supported by the less developed nations and Europe, and they destroy the USA, starting and bringing to an end the Third World War within the space of a year. A golden age of cooperation, good will, and enlightenment follows.
- 2531AD – The Ark becomes the first generation-ship to colonise and terraform a star system other than the Sun's. Space is rapidly colonised following the invention of the Immelmann jump drive.
- 2900AD – The Imperium is founded.
- 3560AD – **The heyday of the Imperium**, a time of maximum control of the core worlds, although the Imperium finds unrest in some outlying areas in the shape of the Crimson Rebels. The Great droid war takes place. The first significant alien contacts occur.
- 3600AD – Knowledege of the rebellion spreads further to the frontier colonies. The idea that the Imperium could be defied takes hold, and inspires the outcasts, exiles, and convicts there to take up arms against their persecutors. The Crimson Rebel movement, now made up of disparate groups and motivations, aquires a common identity, adopting the religious and ideological basis promoted by its mysterious leadership.
- 3862AD – Discovery of the Harvosette Artifacts by the rebels, consisting of thousands of archives, teachings, and histories detailing the creation, progression, and fortold end of the universe. The rebel leadership develops a pseudo-religious philosophy around the artifacts.
- 4220AD – Over-expansion, costly wars with alien races, and growing religious fundamentalism leads to a breakdown in order. The Imperium is dissolved, and major trading organisations assume control of portions of the old Empire. A new dark age of greed and corruption begins. Aeons of divisiveness, war, and suffering are to follow.
- 4480AD – Sickened by the human race's slide into high-tech barbarism, a powerful, mysterious elite calling themselves the Shepherds retire to the recently re-terraformed Earth and isolate themselves. Not wishing to be threatened or discovered by those they see as barbarians and animals, they arrest the evolution of the rest of humanity and of the known intelligent alien races, ensuring that their intelligence is capped for eternity. This is achieved through a vast, secret programme of genetic alteration, achieved through a purpose built, self-replicating virus carried via the food chain. Knowledge of Earth becomes obscured. Many begin to treat the story of Earth as simply a creation myth. Knowledge is lost, and the origin of the species becomes unclear. The Dark Age continues.
- 10764AD – The human race, by its actions, reveals itself to be the most collectively aggressive, expansionist species in the universe, and thus the **Great Ten Thousand Year War** begins; a coalition of alien races pitting their will and military might against humanity. The prize: mastery of the universe.
- 13330AD – With the human race on the brink of extinction, the Crimson Rebels put aside their grievances and internal squabbling and join forces with the near exhausted armies of humanity.
- 20843AD – After millennia of exterminations and atrocities from both sides, the final battle is won by humans. The other races, though not extinguished, are ghettoised. They are ruthlessly oppressed, and forbidden from ever again possessing heavy military assets.
- 20980AD – The human and economic cost of the War takes its toll, and, in the face of disorder and rebellion, the trading organisations lose their power. The military bases keeping watch on the defeated alien races are maintained to try to quell the constant uprisings, but elsewhere the universe is fractured into many smaller, squabbling empires, and the Dark Age deepens.
- 27682AD – The emancipation of the alien races. But by now, humanity has such a stranglehold on the universe that even another alien alliance couldn't seriously threaten human interests.
- 10^{15}AD – About this time, human intelligence-capping is partially circumvented by the creation of 'constructs'. Colloquially known as 'toasties', constructs are living, sentient beings, usually in humanoid form, constructed using organic sampling and nano-technology. A group of hyper-intelligent constructs are created to work on the problem of proton decay, a natural process slowly killing the universe. The constructs discover a method to arrest the decay of the universe, and four galaxies are protected from the ravages of proton decay, quantum-tunnelling, and the like, whilst the rest of the universe begins to evaporate. But the solution, whilst stable for aeons, is ultimately only temporary.

- Approximately 6,500,000 years prior to the founding of the UCH (see below) Earth is rediscovered by the Fifth Galaxy expedition. The Shepherds have by now evolved into the Spheres. In contrast, in evolutionary and technological terms, the rest of humanity has almost stood still since 6010AD. The expedition's startling findings, not all of which are understood by the expedition at the time, are kept secret. An role is created by the Order known as the Voice of the Order of the Wheel, and the secret of the Shepherds and the Spheres is entrusted to that one person. The information is handed down through the generations by the Voice choosing their successor before they die. Soon no other being alive remembers the expedition.
- UCH1 – The Engaged Order of the Wheel, an engaged Buddhist order, forces unification of the Four Galaxies, outlaws private enterprise and profit, oversees the latest ratification of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, establish the Universal Council of Humanity, and sets up the Sacred Band, an elite military unit of 150 pairs of lovers in dreadnought armour, to help planetary defense forces to finally enforce liberty and equality of outcome throughout the universe. The other intelligent races, hitherto oppressed and ghettoised, are emancipated and given the same rights as humans.
- Every intelligent being is provided with an 'aide', which is essentially a small, badge-sized link to the yoodee (the Universal Database) combined with a personal nano-factory. Each aide controls a small but powerful cloud of microscopic nanobot assemblers which can convert organic matter to food, and can convert other raw materials to any other items desired, provided the pattern for the item is present as a plug-in for the aide. Every aide is inbuilt with precisely the same limits on use of raw materials, These limits are generous and allow for a luxurious standard of living for everyone. There are few unattainable objects of desire, for if the user becomes bored with one thing, he or she can simply disassemble it and assemble something else.
- A new beginning is made with regard to marking the passage of time – years are now preceded by the initials UCH (Universal Council of Humanity).
- UCH473 – The Order of the Wheel is victorious in the bloody and brutal Persephonid Campaign. Persephony was a star system controlled by a ruthless local dictator called Agerak Terlaw Issmos, who built a private army and declared independence from the UCH. He confiscated and outlawed the aides of all of the people of Persephony except those of his most trusted henchmen. He reverted to the old ways of advantage and profiteering, building his own fortune and power through punishing taxes, and conquering neighbouring systems. There were several uprisings against Issmos, but all were mercilessly quelled by his elite Terror Guard units. Many atrocities and massacres were committed during Issmos' rule.
- The UCH watched the developing Persephonid crisis keenly, this being it's first real test. Would it have the stomach and the consensus to enforce the new universal order? After several years of debate and deliberation, and after having its diplomatic efforts rebuffed by Issmos' government, the UCH resolved to enforce compliance. The entire Sacred Band, supported by a large Order of the Wheel expeditionary force, after months of hard fighting, finally overcame Issmos' army at the climactic Battle of Anees, Persephony's main world. Issmos himself was never captured. Unfortunately, there are still many that admire his infamous achievements.
- UCH566 – The standard year of the events described in the novel, **Borrowed Time**. The Order of the Wheel is in schism; some within the Order support an 'interventionist' policy supporting research designed to save the four galaxies from the ravages of proton decay. Others support a 'continuationist' policy in opposition to said research, preferring instead to let the universe die as nature intended, thus preserving the eternal cycle of life and death. The two factions are being driven farther apart all the time, and there have been skirmishes and murders. The novel details the heroic struggle of Sof, a young female monk of the Order of the Wheel, to bring permanent salvation to the Four Galaxies in the face of violent Continuationist opposition.

SUGGESTED GAME TIMEZONES

The timeline above spans an unimaginably long time period, and some war theaters, weapons, equipment, vehicles and Aliens are only available at certain points along this line. Please see the 5 'ERA' supplements which detail what weapons and equipment can be used in each Era, along with Era specific rules, weapons, vehicles and equipment, background and other information. Note that some ranges of miniature figures will only be usable in some eras.

The Contemporary Era (Up to 2010 AD)
Ancient and Contemporary class weapons only, battles between Humans only, No Alien contacts. Supplement written to allow Modern day war-gamers to use Beamstrike rules system.

The Segregation Era (circa 2300-2500 AD)
Ancient and Contemporary class weapons only (See the weapons notes below for classifications), battles between Humans only, No Alien contacts (except, perhaps the Greys).

The Imperial Era (circa 3500-4500 AD)
No far future weapons allowed (FFU). Conflict and skirmishes between Imperial forces and Rebels common. Great droid war battles may be staged. Aliens may be used as mercenary forces, attached to Human armies. Large scale battles between Human and alien forces unlikely with the exception of the Bugs.

The Great Ten Thousand Years War Era (circa 10,800- 20,800 AD) …..BOOKLET NOT YET AVAILABLE
Any weapons allowed. Battles will largely take place between Human forces and aliens. War between Human factions unlikely.

The Borrowed Time Era (UCH 1 onwards)
Any weapons allowed. 'Persephonid crisis'

OTHER MATERIAL AVAILABLE

A dedicated Yahoo group is online for Beamstrike, and the latest version of the rules, and all supplements available are posted there. Check this out at:
http://games.groups.yahoo.com/group/Beamstrike_Sci-fi_Game/?yguid=231751639

The Science fiction novel 'Borrowed Time' by Don Clarke, is set during the latter section of the timeline presented above (UCH 566).

"The Four Galaxies are all that remains of the universe near the end of time. Minaxee, an exceptional talent, has almost completed work that will forever protect humanity from the ravages of proton decay. But not everyone wants the universe saved. In a time of intergalactic peace, the Continuationists are prepared to kill to preserve the sacred cycle of life and death. Sof, a young monk, tortured by self-doubt and a troubled past, leaves her homeworld to complete what she thinks is a routine task for the Order of the Wheel. Unwittingly, she is fated to play a starring role in the ultimate conflict"

'A vivid and colourful alternative universe with its own rules and customs and history. The conflict between the Interventionists and Continuationists intrigues' THE LITERARY CONSULTANCY

MINIATURE AVAILABILITY

A full range of metal miniatures (both figures and vehicles) are available from 15mm.co.uk (Laserburn and HOF ranges), Ground Zero Games (GZG), Old Crow Models and Spriggan miniatures. In some sections of the rules, the manufacturer, and model number are listed, as a guide to model availability. Of course miniatures from many other suppliers can be alternatively used.

Abbreviations are OC= Old Crow model, GZG= Ground Zero Games model, 15MM= 15mm.co.uk model.

Old Crow Models: (The 15mm range) **http://www.oldcrowmodels.co.uk/15mm.htm**
Ground Zero Games: (The SG 15 vehicles) **http://www.gtns.co.uk/store1/**
15mm.co.uk (Laserburn and HOF ranges) **http://www.15mm.co.uk/index.htm**
Spriggan Miniatures (Spugs etc.) **http://www.sprigganminiatures.co.uk/index.html**

USING ANOTHER BACKGROUND/ SCALE

Although written with the above Beamstrike/ Borrowed Time background in mind, and using generic 15mm metal miniatures, you are by no means 'locked into' this science fiction universe. This rules set is generic enough to be used with any other 15mm figures, in any science fictional background that takes your fancy. The rules give enough examples of troop types, weapons systems possible and vehicle types to allow the insertion or customisation of vehicles and troop classifications as desired from your favorite sci- fi 'verse'.
It is possible to play Beamstrike with larger figures, such as the popular 25-28mm ranges available, using the same scales for firing and movement, but we would highly recommend sticking to 15mm. This allows for 'larger scale' battles, is much cheaper than purchasing large figures, and makes assembling and painting your armies much easier. The range of 15mm miniature figures and vehicles for science fiction (and other genres) is large, and you may mix and match whatever figures you like and even get creative and write your own army backgrounds and rules.

SECTION 6-ALIENS

This section has grown into its own separate supplement, please see 'Beamstrike Aliens' for details of more than a dozen Alien races and notes for their use in Beamstrike games. Each Alien race has a miniature range available from manufacturers such as 15mm.co.uk, Ground Zero Games, Spriggan miniatures, and Pendrakken miniatures.

SECTION 7- CREDITS, NOTES AND PLAY AIDS

CREDITS/ REFERENCES

A big thanks to everyone who has been involved in the Beamstrike game, and special thanks to Neil's wife Annette for her patience while Neil was sat typing the rules for hours on end!

Game designed and written by Neil Cooper, Don Clarke and Ian Garbutt.
Background timeline by Don Clarke, from novel ' Borrowed Time', by Don Clarke.
Cover art dropship used with permission.
Internal Illustrations and photos by Neil Cooper and Ian Garbutt, various manufacturers miniatures shown.
Vehicle rules based on Wes Camps unofficial Imperial Commander Tank rules, developed by Ian Garbutt.
Playtesting and contributions from the Beamstrike Yahoo group.

Other game systems, rules and reference material Beamstrike was inspired by:

- Imperial Commander, © Tabletop Games 1981
- Laserburn, © Tabletop Games 1980
- Fast and Dirty, the free Sci-Fi rules by Ivan Sorensen
- Guns, Guns, Guns, weapon design system, BTRC, Greg Porter
- Stargrunt 2, Ground Zero Games, Jon Tuffley.
- Chain Reaction 2- Broken Earth- Spugs army lists.
- Warhammer 40K, © Games Workshop Ltd
- Star Wars, Aliens, Matrix and many more sci- fi movies!

OTHER BEAMSTRIKE BOOKLETS

All available from the Beamstrike Yahoo group (requires free registration), or directly from http://www.neilandannettec.myby.co.uk/beamstrike.htm

- CHARTS PACK (Required to play)
- QUICK REFERENCE SHEETS
- RULE SUPPLEMENT 1 (Aircraft building)
- ERA1 Imperial
- ERA 2 Borrowed Time
- ERA 3 Segregation
- ERA 4 Contemporary
- ALIEN RACES
- ALIEN CHART PACK (Required for Alien races use)
- URBAN WARS (Rule sand ideas for city based battles)

BEAMSTRIKE COUNTER SHEET

No Crew	No Crew	No Crew	No Crew	No Crew	No Crew	No Crew	No Crew	No Crew	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	1
SUPP	SUPP	SUPP	SUPP	SUPP	SUPP	SUPP	SUPP	SUPP	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	1
SUPP	SUPP	SUPP	SUPP	SUPP	SUPP	SUPP	SUPP	SUPP	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	1
SUPP	SUPP	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	1
MALFUNC	MALFUNC	MALFUNC	MALFUNC	MALFUNC	MALFUNC	MALFUNC	MALFUNC	MALFUNC	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	1
Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	2
Shield UP	Shield UP	Shield UP	Shield UP	Shield UP	Shield DOWN	Shield DOWN	Shield DOWN	Shield DOWN	Shield DOWN	Shield DOWN	
Deploy	Deploy	Deploy	Deploy	Deploy	Deploy	Deploy	Deploy	Deploy	Deploy	Deploy	2
Shield UP	Shield UP	Shield UP	Shield UP	Shield UP	Shield DOWN	Shield DOWN	Shield DOWN	Shield DOWN	Shield DOWN	Shield DOWN	3
STUN	STUN	STUN	STUN	STUN	STUN	STUN	STUN	STUN	STUN	STUN	3
Conceal	Conceal	Immob	Immob	Immob	Immob	Immob	No guns	No guns	No guns	No guns	3
Conceal	Conceal	Conceal	Conceal	Conceal	Conceal	Conceal	Conceal	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	Glancing Hit	4
Hidden A	Hidden B	Hidden C	Hidden D	Hidden E	Hidden F	Hidden G	Hidden H	Hidden I	Hidden J	Hidden K	4
A	B	C	1	2	3	4	5	STASIS	ITEM	ITEM	5
ARMY SHAKEN		ARMY SHAKEN		ARMY BROKEN		ARMY BROKEN		STASIS	ITEM	ITEM	5
								A	B	C	6

KEY TO TERMS

Ammo Break : Ammo/ breakdown marker
No crew: No crew in the vehicle
Glancing hit: Glancing hit effect for troop
ITEM: Mission specific objective./target/ item
Malfunc.: Malfunction marker for robots.
Stun: Figure is currently stunned
Immob: Vehicle is immobilized
A,B,C : Support targeter markers
Supp: Squad is suppressed

No Guns: Vehicle has weapons knocked out
Conceal: Figure/ unit concealed
Deploy: Deployment marker for snipers/ MGs etc
Hidden A: Hidden unit/ item/ objective markers
Shaken: Army is shaken
Broken: Army is broken
STASIS: Stasis explosion effect area
Shield up/ down: Shield status of figure/ vehicle.

BEAMSTRIKE WEAPON / ITEM NOTES

The weapons of Beamstrike are light and deadly, and very often a hit means a trooper is removed from play after that fire phase. This section outlines some of the weapons from the weapon tables, for those unfamiliar with science fiction small arms. Where games are being played between forces of differing technological levels, you may wish to restrict the weapons available. Next to the weapon classes below, a letter designates which tech level weapons of this kind appeared.

ANC=Ancient times, **CON**= Contemporary, around 1950- 2050 AD, **FUT**= Future weapons theoretically possible, but as yet (circa 2007) not implemented as man portable battlefield versions. **FFU**= Far future, very difficult to see how these weapons could exist as firearms or portable, effective, heavy/ vehicle weapons.

LASERS (FUT)
Laser weapons fire a narrow, concentrated beam of coherent light, with enough energy to melt steel and vaporise flesh. The beam fired is a very short lived 'pulse'. Lasers have no moving parts, so are very reliable, but lack hard hitting power/ impact against armoured targets and vehicles. Lasers have excellent range and are easy to achieve hits with.

CPP GUNS (CON)
CPP stands for chemically propelled projectile. CPP guns fire metal bullets propelled by a powder filled cartridge, and are descendants of the firearms of the earlier centuries of mankind's history. Reasonable 'all round' weapons. Some types are capable of burst template fire in addition to long range attacks. Have medium to short range, and medium impact. The sniper rifle is a more powerful, long range larger calibre CPP weapon, while the advanced assault rifle, or 'pulse' rifle may fire bullets or any support grenade due to its under-slung grenade launcher (equivalent to riot gun). The long rifle is a more archaic bolt action rifle having good range but limited power.

GYROBOLT GUNS (CON)
A type of CPP weapon, but listed separately as have different ballistic characteristics. Miniature, explosive tipped rocket firing weapons, bolters are heavy, noisy and powerful small arms. Massive impact values are off set by moderate range. The heavy and support bolters can take out light to medium unshielded vehicles.

FLAMERS (CON)
Firing burning napalm-like chemicals in a template type zone, flamers are hard hitting but short ranged.

SUN WEAPONS (FUT)
Firing superheated, burning chemicals at high velocity, sun weapons inflict massive damage at close range and can take out light to medium vehicles as no shields protect against this weapon class. The plasma gun fires its jet over a longer distance but has less impact than the sun gun. Pitfalls of sun weapons are poor range, and ONLY PA/ AD/ Vehicles may use them due to danger to the firer.

GAUSS RIFLE (light mass gun) (FFU)
Very long, heavy 'bullpup' rifle uses an electrically induced magnetic field to accelerate an iron cored projectile to high velocity down a smoothbore spiral barrel (allows longer barrel length for length of gun), projectile spin imparted by magnetic bias in acceleration coils. High impact weapon, long ranged. Expensive.

LAUNCHERS (Cartridge pistol, Grenade. and missile launcher, Bazooka, riot gun) (CON)
Compact and lightweight indirect fire weapons may fire any grenade from the 'advanced' selection. Give a wide range of battlefield applications from giving troops smoke cover, to attacking vehicles and ground troops. Wide burst areas of grenades can take down lots of troops in one go if they have poor cover levels. Direct fire is used where line of sight exists to the target, 'indirect' fire can be used if a comrade has 'spotted' the target and the launcher is equipped with a support targeter. In the indirect role the launcher needs no line of sight to the target so that the firer may remain hidden.

LASER/ BOLT CANNON (FUT)
Light, turret, tripod or vehicle mounted support weapons, the cannons add extra long range fire support to ground troops.

LAW PISTOL (CON)
Favoured by some law enforcement officers, the enforcer pistol is a hybrid weapon capable of firing as a bolt pistol, but also able to select less lethal 'stun' rounds, depending on the circumstances. High points cost, close range only.

RAMJET/ ROCKET PISTOL (CON)
Hard to hit with, short ranged, but useful heavy close firepower backup in a compact package. Fires a 'ramjet' rocket, which uses air forced into the front of the rocket to further accelerate it in flight. Very short ranged, but packs the same impact power as a support bolter.

P-BEAM RIFLE (FFU)
High tech- level particle beam (P- beam) rifle, very loud, requires huge amounts of energy to fire. P- beams have no recoil, are largely unaffected by atmospheric conditions, and very accurate. The particle chosen for a beam weapon must have good penetration but must interact sufficiently with the target matter in order to damage it.

NEEDLE RIFLE (FUT)
Needle guns fire tiny 'needles' of super- frozen chemical at high velocity. Chemicals used are often strong sedatives, drugs or poisons. Of limited use on the battlefield due to poor range and armour penetration, but included here for completeness.
ANTI-MATTER BEAMER (FUT) projects a narrow beam of anti- matter energy which can disrupt flesh, plasticrete and armour alike. Damage is variable depending how the beam hits the target and the damage type is rolled on a 1d6. The anti-matter beamer is classed as a squad support weapon.

BLAST WEAPONS(FUT) are high- Imperium versions of Laser weapons, the laser beam is augmentated with pulses of charged particles, increasing laser damages to near bolt weapon levels, but retaining laser accuracy and reliability. Blast weapons are not in general Imperial use, but may be found within specialist units. If you are 'Generic' gaming in the 'Star Wars' universe with these rules, blast weapons are the standard Imperial weapon.

SMARTGUN(FUT), with an integral carry harness is basically a machinegun with improved targeting abilities.
This type of weapon features in the movie 'Aliens', and may be issued to early Company and Imperial armies.
Power and range are exactly as per machinegun, but it counts as having a built inTargetter (but you cannot add another Targetter to it for a double bonus!) and any cover a target is in has a -1 penalty to it.
The 'to hit' figures on the weapon chart INCLUDE the Targetter bonus. The gun also allows the targeting of a unit directly behind a closer unit (normally not allowed, see page 13, core rules), ad targets can be chosen as if troops firing the smart gun were one level higher than they actually are (see chart page 13, eligible targets). Weapon is expensive for a standard damage item. Note the smartgun is classed as a squad support weapon.

HEAVY SNIPER RIFLE (FUT)
This is a large caliber rifle having power comparable to bolt weapons, but still firing a metal slug. Only troops with sniper skill may use this item. Rifle has integral silencer and recoiless action, making it ideal for long range anti-personnel and light anti-material use.

SONIC RIFLE (FUT) can be found in use by police forces on some planets, but is not generally a weapon used by regular military units. The sonic rifle 'emits a tightly focused burst of sound waves, in the low frequency range which can 'blow back' and stun an opponent. Useful for stunning enemies or holding them from advancing. Sometimes used to control civilians in riot situations. The sonic gun has spread and intensity settings allowing it to use ANY template for fire effect, or a 'long' ranged attack up to 10 inches.
Note that the Sonic gun is NOT effective against power or dreadnought armour, as these armours have in-built sonic protection, also protecting against shell-shock and explosive type sonic damage.
If a hit is achieved on LA,FI or UA troops roll 1d6: 1-4= Glancing hit, 5-6=Stun. A hit achieved on PA/ AD or a vehicle has no effect.

ANTI-MATERIEL RIFLE (CON)
A predecessor to the Gyrobolt gun, this monster fires a 17mm bolt with a shaped charged at its tip, and able to penetrate light to medium unshielded vehicles. Very long and heavy, this weapon must be deployed before being fired. Long ranged and usually fitted with advanced scope and integral bipod and muzzle brake/ compensator.

POWER GLOVE (FUT)
Armour plated, form fitting, exoskeletal, servo spowered 'glove' with large power supply sheathing the glove in a shimmering energy field (similar to power weapon field). Deadly in close combat and able to rip open armoured doors, the power glove is often fitting to suits of armour. Beware anyone wanting a handshake wearing one of these!

FORCE/ POWER SWORD (FUT)
Atomic battery powered melee weapons having a power field surrounding the blade, cuts through most materials like butter and absolutely deadly in close combat when wielded with skill. Tend to be standard military melee weapons.

SWORD/ KNIFE/ CLUB etc (ANC)
Sharpened metal melee weapons from ancient times. Vast array of different types and sizes.

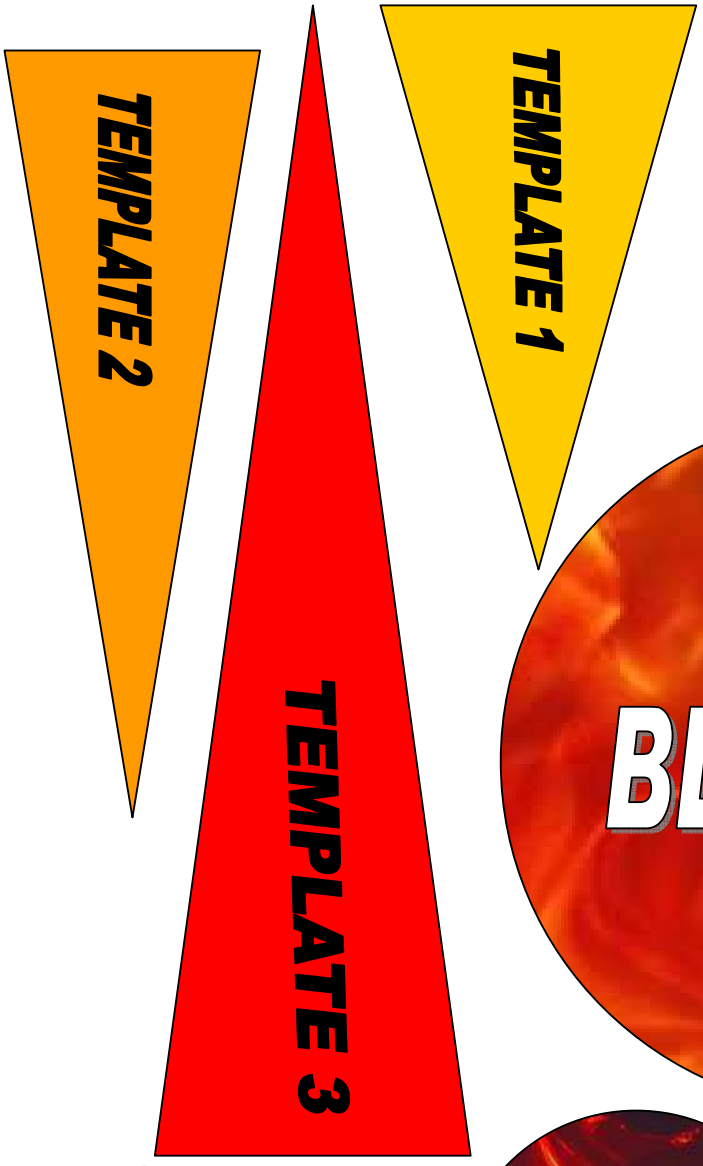
TARGETER (FUT)
A targeter is a futuristic aiming device. A small aiming pod is attached to the weapon, this sends targeting data wirelessly to the users helmet visor. A head –up display (HUD) projects target details, range and aiming suggestions onto the users visor, making acquisition of target and hit chance faster and higher.

VEHICLE MOUNTED WEAPONS:

40-150mm CPP (chemically propelled projectile) guns are the descendants of 20th century tank guns and fire a range of solid projectiles powered by the explosion of a liquid propellant. The exact amount of liquid explosive is pumped into the barrel, just behind the shell immediately before the shot, maximising efficiency and minimising 'blast' from the guns muzzle. There is always a choice of firing the following:
AV (Anti vehicle) round, which does the damage stated, but has no blast diameter (all of the shells energy is directed into and through the targets armour).
HE (High Explosive, Anti- personnel) round, which bursts on impact and is used against soft vehicles, buildings and troops. Roll for hits on all elements within the indicated burst template, using the grenades and indirect fire cover rules.
SMK (Smoke) All CPP type guns may alternatively fire a smoke round, see smoke grenade rules.
Rail gun (Gauss gun, Mass driver) hyper accelerates a monomolecular 'spike' at high velocity, using a strong magnetic field. They have good range and a very flat trajectory.
Vulcan is an antiaircraft rotary machinegun, spitting out around 6000 rounds per minute (100 per second), creating a 'wall' of lead. This gun only has a -2 penalty when firing at aircraft.
Beam cannons are large particle beam projectors, very noisy and powerful, requiring huge energy banks to power them. Effectiveness is reduced if smoke lies in the path of the shot.
Tank Flamethrower is a tank mounted version of the standard flamethrower. Short ranged, but no shields are effective against it.
Sun cannon is a tank mounted version of the sun gun, firing a blast of super heated burning chemical in a high velocity jet, and able to burn through almost anything instantly. No shields protect against it.

BEAMSTRIKE TEMPLATE SHEETS

Print out and stick onto thick card for use. Lamination of templates will provide the best protection and years of use.



Template 1 should be 3 ins long
Template 2 should be 4 in long
Template 3 should be 6 in long
Blast 1 should be 2 in diameter
Blast 2 should be 31/2 in diameter
Blast 3 should be 5 ins diameter
Blast 4 should be 6 ins diameter
Crater should be 2 ins wide

ENERGY
SHIELD
BLAST 3
CRATER
BLAST 2
BLAST 1

ENERGY SHIELD

PROJECTILE SHIELD

BLAST 4

BLAST 1

BLAST 1